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ELECTROSTATIC CHUCK INCLUDING A HEATER ELEMENT WITH MULTIPLE HEATING ZONES

Abstract

An electrostatic chuck includes a ceramic dielectric substrate, a base plate, and a heater unit. The heater unit includes a first heater element. The first heater element includes a first zone, as well as first and second protruding portions. The first zone includes a first facing region in which the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other. The first zone including an inner circumference portion and an outer circumference portion, as well as an outer circumference edge of the first heater element. The outer circumference portion being a portion positioned at the other side in the radial direction of a center line of the radial direction. The outer circumference portion including the outer circumference edge, and the first facing region being located in the inner circumference portion.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/121,353, filed Mar. 14, 2023, which is based upon and claims the benefit of priority from Japanese Patent Application No. 2022-053875, filed on Mar. 29, 2022, No. 2022-154887, filed on Sep. 28, 2022, and No. 2022-154888, filed on Sep. 28, 2022; the entire contents of which are incorporated herein by reference.

FIELD

[0002] Embodiments described herein relate generally to an electrostatic chuck.

BACKGROUND

[0003] In a plasma processing chamber where etching, chemical vapor deposition (CVD), sputtering, ion implantation, ashing, or the like is performed, an electrostatic chuck is used as a member for clamping and holding a process object such as a semiconductor wafer or a glass substrate. The electrostatic chuck applies an electrostatic clamping power to built-in electrodes and clamps a substrate such as a silicon wafer by an electrostatic force.

[0004] In recent years, IC chips including semiconductor elements such as transistors have been required to be miniaturized and improved in processing speed. Along with this requirement, in forming the semiconductor element on a wafer, it is required to improve processing accuracy of etching or the like. The processing accuracy of etching indicates whether or not a pattern having a width and depth as designed can be formed by processing a wafer. By increasing the processing accuracy of etching or the like, the semiconductor element can be miniaturized, and the integration density can be increased. That is, by increasing the processing accuracy, it is possible to reduce the size of the chip and to increase the speed of the chip.

[0005] It is known that a processing accuracy of etching or the like depends on the temperature of a wafer during processing. Therefore, in a substrate processing apparatus having an electrostatic chuck, it is required to control an in-plane temperature distribution of the wafer during the processing in order to allow an etching rate to be uniform. As a method of controlling the in-plane temperature distribution of the wafer, a method of using an electrostatic chuck having an embedded heater (heating element) is known.

[0006] Especially in recent years, along with the miniaturization of semiconductor elements, faster heating and stricter control of the in-plane temperature distribution have been required, and as a method for implementing this, the use of a two-layer structure of a main heater and a sub-heater as a heater is known. Heater patterns when the heater includes multiple zones also are known.

[0007] However, providing multiple zones in the heater allows for fine temperature control, but causes design constraints on the shape of the heater pattern and increases the number of pads, terminals, and the like for feeding power, which results in a new problem, i.e., the degradation of

the uniformity of the temperature distribution in the wafer surface due to the occurrence in the heater plane of many cool spots having relatively low temperatures and hotspots having relatively high temperatures.

[0008] Therefore, for example, it may be considered to increase the uniformity of the temperature distribution in the wafer surface by dispersing the cool spots and the hotspots in the heater plane. However, there is a risk that dispersing the cool spots and the hotspots in the heater plane may make the temperature control complex. It is desirable to increase the uniformity of the temperature distribution in the wafer surface while suppressing complex temperature control.

SUMMARY

[0009] According to the embodiment, an electrostatic chuck includes a ceramic dielectric substrate, a base plate, and a heater unit. The ceramic dielectric substrate has a first major surface and a second major surface. The first major surface is configured to have a process object placed thereon. The second major surface is opposite to the first major surface. The base plate has an upper surface and a lower surface. The upper surface is at the ceramic dielectric substrate side. The lower surface is opposite to the upper surface. The base plate supports the ceramic dielectric substrate. The heater unit heats the ceramic dielectric substrate. The heater unit includes a first heater element and a second heater element. The first heater element is located between the first major surface and the upper surface. The second heater element is located between the first major surface and the first heater element or between the first heater element and the upper surface. The first heater element includes a plurality of zones. The plurality of zones of the first heater element includes a first zone. The first zone includes a first heater line, a first power feeding portion, and a second power feeding portion. The first heater line emits heat by allowing a current to flow. The first power feeding portion and the second power feeding portion feed power to the first heater line. The first heater line includes a plurality of extension portions, and a plurality of protruding portions. The plurality of extension portions extends along a first direction. The plurality of extension portions is arranged in a second direction. the second direction is perpendicular to the first direction. The plurality of protruding portions is provided in the plurality of extension portions. The plurality of protruding portions protrudes in the second direction. The plurality of extension portions includes a first extension portion and a second extension portion. The plurality of protruding portions includes a first protruding portion and a second protruding portion. The first protruding portion is provided in the first extension portion. The second protruding portion is provided in the second extension portion. The first protruding portion protrudes toward the second protruding portion. The second protruding portion protrudes toward the first protruding portion. The first zone includes a first facing region in which the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other. The second heater element includes a plurality of zones. The plurality of zones of the second heater element includes a second zone. The second zone includes a second heater line, a third power feeding portion, and a fourth power feeding portion. The second heater line emits heat by allowing a current to flow. The third power feeding portion and the fourth power feeding portion feeds power to the second heater line. The second zone includes a central region and an outer peripheral region. The central region is positioned at a center of the second zone when viewed along a Z-direction. The Z-direction is perpendicular to the first major surface. The outer peripheral region is positioned outside the central region. The first facing region is located at a position where the first facing region overlaps the central region in the Z-direction.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0010] FIG. 1 is a perspective view schematically illustrating an electrostatic chuck according to an

embodiment;

[0011] FIGS. 2A and 2B are cross-sectional views schematically illustrating portions of the electrostatic chuck according to the embodiment;

[0012] FIG. 3 is an exploded perspective view schematically illustrating the heater unit according to the embodiment;

[0013] FIG. 4 is an exploded cross-sectional view schematically illustrating the heater unit according to the embodiment;

[0014] FIG. 5 is a plan view schematically illustrating main zones of the main heater element according to the embodiment;

[0015] FIG. 6 is a plan view schematically illustrating sub-zones of the sub-heater element according to the embodiment;

[0016] FIG. 7 is a plan view schematically illustrating the positional relationship between the main zones of the main heater element and the sub-zones of the sub-heater element according to the embodiment;

[0017] FIG. 8 is a plan view schematically illustrating a portion of the first zone of the heater unit according to the embodiment;

[0018] FIG. 9 is a plan view schematically illustrating a portion of a first zone of a heater unit according to a modification of the embodiment;

[0019] FIG. 10 is a plan view schematically illustrating a portion of a first zone of a heater unit according to a modification of the embodiment;

[0020] FIG. 11 is a plan view schematically illustrating a portion of a first zone of a heater unit according to a modification of the embodiment;

[0021] FIG. 12 is a plan view schematically illustrating a portion of a first zone of a heater unit according to a modification of the embodiment;

[0022] FIG. 13 is a plan views schematically illustrating the positional relationship between a second zone and a portion of the first zone of the heater unit according to the first embodiment;

[0023] FIG. 14 is a plan views schematically illustrating the positional relationship between a second zone and a portion of the first zone of the heater unit according to the first embodiment;

[0024] FIG. 15 is a plan view schematically illustrating a first zone of a heater unit according to a second embodiment;

[0025] FIG. 16 is a plan view schematically illustrating a first zone of a heater unit according to a third embodiment;

[0026] FIG. 17 is a plan view schematically illustrating a first zone of a heater unit according to a fourth embodiment; and

[0027] FIG. 18 is a plan view schematically illustrating a first zone of a heater unit according to a fifth embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0028] A first invention is an electrostatic chuck including a ceramic dielectric substrate, a base plate supporting the ceramic dielectric substrate, and a heater unit heating the ceramic dielectric substrate; the ceramic dielectric substrate has a first major surface configured to have a process object placed thereon, and a second major surface opposite to the first major surface; the base plate has an upper surface at the ceramic dielectric substrate side and a lower surface opposite to the upper surface; the heater unit includes a first heater element and a second heater element; the first heater element is located between the first major surface and the upper surface; the second heater element is located between the first major surface and the first heater element or between the first heater element and the upper surface; the first heater element includes multiple zones; the multiple zones of the first heater element include a first zone; the first zone includes a first heater line emitting heat by allowing a current to flow, and a first power feeding portion and a second power feeding portion feeding power to the first heater line; the first heater line includes multiple extension portions and multiple protruding portions; the multiple extension portions extend along a

first direction and are arranged in a second direction perpendicular to the first direction; the multiple protruding portions are provided in the multiple extension portions and protrude in the second direction; the multiple extension portions include a first extension portion and a second extension portion; the multiple protruding portions include a first protruding portion provided in the first extension portion, and a second protruding portion provided in the second extension portion; the first protruding portion protrudes toward the second protruding portion; the second protruding portion protrudes toward the first protruding portion; the first zone includes a first facing region in which the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other; the second heater element includes multiple zones; the multiple zones of the second heater element include a second zone; the second zone includes a second heater line emitting heat by allowing a current to flow, and a third power feeding portion and a fourth power feeding portion feeding power to the second heater line; the second zone includes a central region and an outer peripheral region; the central region is positioned at a center of the second zone when viewed along a Z-direction perpendicular to the first major surface; the outer peripheral region is positioned outside the central region when viewed along the Z-direction; and the first facing region is located at a position where the first facing region overlaps the central region in the Z-direction.

[0029] When the number of zones of the heater unit is increased to increase the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object, the number of power feeding portions and the like for feeding power to the zones is increased. When the number of power feeding portions and the like is increased, the number of protruding portions provided in the heater line also is increased to avoid the power feeding portions and the like. Normally, current flows over the shortest distance, so when a current flows in the protruding portion of the heater line, the current flows more easily at the inner side of the protruding portion than at the outer side of the protruding portion. Accordingly, the generated heat amount is likely to be less at the outer side of the protruding portion than at the inner side of the protruding portion. That is, the protruding portions are likely to become cool spots. To increase the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the heater unit, for example, it may be considered to dispose the protruding portions so as to be dispersed in the heater unit plane. However, when the protruding portions are disposed so as to be dispersed in the heater unit plane, there is a risk that temperature control may become complex due to the dispersion of the cool spots. On the other hand, when the protruding portions are disposed so as to be aggregated in the heater unit plane, there is a risk that the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the heater unit may degrade due to the reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots. In contrast, according to the electrostatic chuck, the first facing region of the first zone in which the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other (i.e., the protruding portions are aggregated) is located at a position where the first facing region overlaps the central region, which is likely to have a higher temperature than the outer peripheral region in a second zone. Accordingly, a drastic reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots can be suppressed by suppressing the dispersion of the cool spots and by setting the first facing region of the first zone, i.e., the cool spot, so as to overlap the central region of the second zone, i.e., the hotspot. That is, the temperature unevenness can be canceled. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object can be increased while suppressing complex temperature control.

[0030] A second invention is an electrostatic chuck including a ceramic dielectric substrate, a base plate supporting the ceramic dielectric substrate, and a heater unit heating the ceramic dielectric substrate; the ceramic dielectric substrate has a first major surface configured to have a process object placed thereon, and a second major surface opposite to the first major surface; the base plate has an upper surface at the ceramic dielectric substrate side and a lower surface opposite to the upper surface; the heater unit includes a first heater element; the first heater element is located between the first major surface and the upper surface; the first heater element includes multiple

zones; the multiple zones of the first heater element include a first zone; the first zone includes a first heater line emitting heat by allowing a current to flow, and a first power feeding portion and a second power feeding portion feeding power to the first heater line; the first heater line includes multiple extension portions and multiple protruding portions; the multiple extension portions extend along a first direction and are arranged in a second direction perpendicular to the first direction; the multiple protruding portions are provided in the multiple extension portions and protrude in the second direction; the multiple extension portions include a first extension portion and a second extension portion; the multiple protruding portions include a first protruding portion provided in the first extension portion, and a second protruding portion provided in the second extension portion; the first protruding portion protrudes toward the second protruding portion; the second protruding portion protrudes toward the first protruding portion; the first zone includes a first facing region in which the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other; the first zone includes a central region and an outer peripheral region; the central region is positioned at a center of the first zone when viewed along a Z-direction perpendicular to the first major surface; the outer peripheral region is positioned outside the central region when viewed along the Z-direction; and the first facing region is located in the central region.

[0031] When the number of zones of the heater unit is increased to increase the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object, the number of power feeding portions and the like for feeding power to the zones is increased. When the number of power feeding portions and the like is increased, the number of protruding portions provided in the heater line also is increased to avoid the power feeding portions and the like. Normally, current flows over the shortest distance, so when a current flows in the protruding portion of the heater line, the current flows more easily at the inner side of the protruding portion than at the outer side of the protruding portion. Accordingly, the generated heat amount is likely to be less at the outer side of the protruding portion than at the inner side of the protruding portion. That is, the protruding portions are likely to become cool spots. To increase the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the heater unit, for example, it may be considered to dispose the protruding portions so as to be dispersed in the heater unit plane. However, when the protruding portions are disposed so as to be dispersed in the heater unit plane, there is a risk that temperature control may become complex due to the dispersion of the cool spots. On the other hand, when the protruding portions are disposed so as to be aggregated in the heater unit plane, there is a risk that the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the heater unit may degrade due to the reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots. In contrast, according to the electrostatic chuck, the first facing region of the first zone in which the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other (i.e., the protruding portions are aggregated) is located in the central region, which is likely to have a higher temperature than the outer peripheral region in the first zone. Accordingly, a drastic reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots can be suppressed by suppressing the dispersion of the cool spots and by providing the first facing region of the first zone, i.e., the cool spot, in the central region of the first zone, i.e., the hotspot. That is, the temperature unevenness can be canceled. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object can be increased while suppressing complex temperature control.

[0032] A third invention is an electrostatic chuck including a ceramic dielectric substrate, a base plate supporting the ceramic dielectric substrate, and a heater unit heating the ceramic dielectric substrate; the ceramic dielectric substrate has a first major surface configured to have a process object placed thereon, and a second major surface opposite to the first major surface; the base plate has an upper surface at the ceramic dielectric substrate side and a lower surface opposite to the upper surface; the heater unit includes a first heater element; the first heater element is located between the first major surface and the upper surface; the first heater element includes multiple zones divided in a radial direction; the multiple zones of the first heater element include a first

zone; the first zone includes a first heater line emitting heat by allowing a current to flow, and a first power feeding portion and a second power feeding portion feeding power to the first heater line; the first heater line includes multiple extension portions and multiple protruding portions; the multiple extension portions extend along a first direction and are arranged in a second direction perpendicular to the first direction; the multiple protruding portions are provided in the multiple extension portions and protrude in the second direction; the multiple extension portions includes a first extension portion and a second extension portion; the multiple protruding portions include a first protruding portion provided in the first extension portion, and a second protruding portion provided in the second extension portion; the first protruding portion protrudes toward the second protruding portion; the second protruding portion protrudes toward the first protruding portion; the first zone includes a first facing region in which the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other; the first zone includes an outer circumference edge of the first heater element; the first zone includes an inner circumference portion and an outer circumference portion; the inner circumference portion is positioned radially inward of a center line of the radial direction; the center line of the radial direction bisects the first zone in the radial direction; the outer circumference portion includes the outer circumference edge and is positioned radially outward of the center line of the radial direction; and the first facing region is located in the inner circumference portion.

[0033] When the number of zones of the heater unit is increased to increase the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object, the number of power feeding portions and the like for feeding power to the zones is increased. When the number of power feeding portions and the like is increased, the number of protruding portions provided in the heater line also is increased to avoid the power feeding portions and the like. Normally, current flows over the shortest distance, so when a current flows in the protruding portion of the heater line, the current flows more easily at the inner side of the protruding portion than at the outer side of the protruding portion. Accordingly, the generated heat amount is likely to be less at the outer side of the protruding portion than at the inner side of the protruding portion. That is, the protruding portions are likely to become cool spots. To increase the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the heater unit, for example, it may be considered to dispose the protruding portions so as to be dispersed in the heater unit plane. However, when the protruding portions are disposed so as to be dispersed in the heater unit plane, there is a risk that temperature control may become complex due to the dispersion of the cool spots. On the other hand, when the protruding portions are disposed so as to be aggregated in the heater unit plane, there is a risk that the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the heater unit may degrade due to the reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots. The outermost circumference portion of the process object is likely to have a lower temperature than the inner portion. In contrast, according to the electrostatic chuck, when the first zone includes the outer circumference edge of the first heater element (i.e., the first zone is positioned at the outermost circumference portion of the first heater element), the first facing region of the first zone in which the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other (i.e., the protruding portions are aggregated) is located in the inner circumference portion of the first zone, which is likely to have a higher temperature than the outer circumference portion of the first zone. Accordingly, a drastic reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots can be suppressed by suppressing the dispersion of the cool spots and by providing the first facing region of the first zone, i.e., the cool spot, in the inner circumference portion of the first zone, i.e., the hotspot. That is, the temperature unevenness can be canceled. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object can be increased while suppressing complex temperature control.

[0034] A fourth invention is the electrostatic chuck of any one of the first to third inventions, wherein the multiple zones of the first heater element are divided in a radial direction, and the first direction is a circumferential direction.

[0035] According to the electrostatic chuck, the control of the in-plane temperature of the process object can be efficiently performed.

[0036] A fifth invention is the electrostatic chuck of any one of the first to third inventions, wherein the multiple zones of the first heater element are divided in a radial direction, and the first direction is the radial direction.

[0037] According to the electrostatic chuck, the control of the in-plane temperature of the process object can be efficiently performed.

[0038] A sixth invention is the electrostatic chuck of any one of the first to third inventions, wherein the multiple extension portions further include a third extension portion positioned between the first extension portion and the second extension portion in the second direction, and the third extension portion is located at a position where the third extension portion does not overlap the first and second protruding portions in the second direction.

[0039] The first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other. Therefore, there are cases where the shortest distance between the first extension portion and the second extension portion is greater than the shortest distance when the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are not formed.

[0040] According to the electrostatic chuck, the area of the first facing region can be relatively small because the third extension portion is disposed between the first extension portion and the second extension portion at a position where the third extension portion does not overlap the first and second protruding portions. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object can be increased.

[0041] A seventh invention is the electrostatic chuck of any one of the first to third inventions, wherein the multiple protruding portions further include a third protruding portion that is located in the first extension portion and protrudes toward the second protruding portion; and the third protruding portion is disposed so as to face and be adjacent to the second protruding portion.

[0042] According to the electrostatic chuck, the number of cool spots in the entire plane can be relatively low by disposing a region (a second facing region) in which the second protruding portion and the third protruding portion are aggregated proximate to the first facing region. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object can be increased while suppressing complex temperature control.

[0043] An eighth invention is an electrostatic chuck including a ceramic dielectric substrate, a base plate supporting the ceramic dielectric substrate, and a heater unit heating the ceramic dielectric substrate; the ceramic dielectric substrate has a first major surface configured to have a process object placed thereon, and a second major surface opposite to the first major surface; the base plate has an upper surface at the ceramic dielectric substrate side and a lower surface opposite to the upper surface; the heater unit includes a first heater element; the first heater element is located between the first major surface and the upper surface; the first heater element includes multiple zones; the multiple zones of the first heater element include a first zone; the first zone includes a first heater line emitting heat by allowing a current to flow, and a first power feeding portion and a second power feeding portion feeding power to the first heater line; the first heater line includes a first protruding portion and a second protruding portion that are curved; a curve direction of the first protruding portion is the opposite of a curve direction of the second protruding portion; the first zone includes a first facing region in which the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other; the first zone includes a central region and an outer peripheral region; the central region is positioned at a center of the first zone when viewed along a Z-direction perpendicular to the first major surface; the outer peripheral region is positioned outside the central region when viewed along the Z-direction; and the first facing region is located in the central region.

[0044] When the number of zones of the heater unit is increased to increase the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object, the number of power feeding portions and

the like for feeding power to the zones is increased. When the number of the power feeding portions and the like is increased, the number of protruding portions provided in the heater line to avoid the power feeding portions and the like also is increased. Normally, current flows over the shortest distance, so when a current flows in the protruding portion of the heater line, the current flows more easily at the inner side of the protruding portion than at the outer side of the protruding portion. Accordingly, the generated heat amount is likely to be less at the outer side of the protruding portion than at the inner side of the protruding portion. That is, the protruding portions are likely to become cool spots. To increase the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the heater unit, for example, it may be considered to dispose the protruding portions so as to be dispersed in the heater unit plane. However, when the protruding portions are disposed so as to be dispersed in the heater unit plane, there is a risk that temperature control may become complex due to the dispersion of the cool spots. On the other hand, when the protruding portions are disposed so as to be aggregated in the heater unit plane, there is a risk that the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the heater unit may degrade due to the reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots. In contrast, according to the electrostatic chuck, the first facing region of the first zone in which the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other (i.e., the protruding portions are aggregated) is located in the central region, which is likely to have a higher temperature than the outer peripheral region of the first zone. Accordingly, a drastic reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots can be suppressed by suppressing the dispersion of the cool spots and by providing the first facing region of the first zone, i.e., the cool spot, in the central region of the first zone, i.e., the hotspot. That is, the temperature unevenness can be canceled. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object can be increased while suppressing complex temperature control.

[0045] A ninth invention is an electrostatic chuck including a ceramic dielectric substrate, a base plate supporting the ceramic dielectric substrate, and a heater unit heating the ceramic dielectric substrate; the ceramic dielectric substrate has a first major surface configured to have a process object placed thereon, and a second major surface opposite to the first major surface; the base plate has an upper surface at the ceramic dielectric substrate side and a lower surface opposite to the upper surface, and includes a coolant flow path for allowing a cooling medium to flow; the heater unit includes a first heater element, a bypass layer, and a first power feeding terminal and a second power feeding terminal electrically connected to the bypass layer; the bypass layer is a power feeding path to the first heater element; the first heater element is located between the first major surface and the upper surface; the first heater element includes multiple zones; the multiple zones of the first heater element include a first zone; the first zone includes a first heater line emitting heat by allowing a current to flow, and a first power feeding portion and a second power feeding portion feeding power to the first heater line; the first power feeding portion is electrically connected to the first power feeding terminal via the bypass layer, and is located at a position where the first power feeding portion does not overlap the first power feeding terminal in a Z-direction perpendicular to the first major surface; the second power feeding portion is electrically connected to the second power feeding terminal via the bypass layer, and is located at a position where the second power feeding portion does not overlap the second power feeding terminal in the Z-direction; the first heater line includes multiple extension portions and multiple protruding portions; the multiple extension portions extend along a first direction and are arranged in a second direction perpendicular to the first direction; the multiple protruding portions are provided in the multiple extension portions and protrude in the second direction; the multiple extension portions include a first extension portion and a second extension portion; the multiple protruding portions include a first protruding portion provided in the first extension portion, and a second protruding portion provided in the second extension portion; the first protruding portion protrudes toward the second protruding portion; the second protruding portion protrudes toward the first protruding portion; the first zone includes a first facing region in which the first protruding portion and the

second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other; and the first facing region is located at a position where the first facing region overlaps at least one of the first power feeding terminal or the second power feeding terminal in the Z-direction.

[0046] When the number of zones of the heater unit is increased to increase the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object, the number of power feeding portions and the like for feeding power to the zones is increased. When the number of the power feeding portions and the like is increased, the number of protruding portions provided in the heater line to avoid the power feeding portions and the like also is increased. Normally, current flows over the shortest distance, so when a current flows in the protruding portion of the heater line, the current flows more easily at the inner side of the protruding portion than at the outer side of the protruding portion. Accordingly, the generated heat amount is likely to be less at the outer side of the protruding portion than at the inner side of the protruding portion. That is, the protruding portions are likely to become cool spots. To increase the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the heater unit, for example, it may be considered to dispose the protruding portions so as to be dispersed in the heater unit plane. However, when the protruding portions are disposed so as to be dispersed in the heater unit plane, there is a risk that temperature control may become complex due to the dispersion of the cool spots. On the other hand, when the protruding portions are disposed so as to be aggregated in the heater unit plane, there is a risk that the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the heater unit may degrade due to the reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots. Even when the coolant flow path for allowing the cooling medium to flow is provided inside the base plate, the coolant flow path is not provided at the position at which the power feeding terminal for feeding power to the bypass layer is located. Therefore, the position at which the power feeding terminal is located is difficult to cool compared to the other positions and is likely to become a hotspot. In contrast, according to the electrostatic chuck, the first facing region of the first zone in which the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other (i.e., the protruding portions are aggregated) is located at a position where the first facing region overlaps at least one of the first power feeding terminal or the second power feeding terminal. Accordingly, a drastic reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots can be suppressed by suppressing the dispersion of the cool spots and by setting the first facing region of the first zone, i.e., the cool spot, so as to overlap the first power feeding terminal and/or the second power feeding terminal, i.e., the hotspots. That is, the temperature unevenness can be canceled. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object can be increased while suppressing complex temperature control.

[0047] A tenth invention is the electrostatic chuck of the ninth invention, wherein the first zone includes a central region and an outer peripheral region; the central region is positioned at a center of the first zone when viewed along the Z-direction; the outer peripheral region is positioned outside the central region when viewed along the Z-direction; and the first facing region is located in the central region.

[0048] According to the electrostatic chuck, the first facing region of the first zone is located in the central region that is likely to have a higher temperature than the outer peripheral region in the first zone. Accordingly, a drastic reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots can be suppressed by setting the first facing region of the first zone, i.e., the cool spot, so as to overlap the central region of the first zone, i.e., the hotspot. That is, the temperature unevenness can be canceled.

Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object can be increased while suppressing complex temperature control.

[0049] An eleventh invention is the electrostatic chuck of the ninth invention, wherein the multiple zones of the first heater element are divided in a radial direction; and the first direction is a circumferential direction.

[0050] According to the electrostatic chuck, the control of the in-plane temperature of the process object can be efficiently performed.

[0051] A twelfth invention is the electrostatic chuck of the ninth invention, wherein the multiple zones of the first heater element are divided in a radial direction; and the first direction is the radial direction.

[0052] According to the electrostatic chuck, the control of the in-plane temperature of the process object can be efficiently performed.

[0053] A thirteenth invention is the electrostatic chuck of any one of the ninth to twelfth inventions, wherein the multiple extension portions further include a third extension portion positioned between the first extension portion and the second extension portion in the second direction; and the third extension portion is located at a position where the third extension portion does not overlap the first and second protruding portions in the second direction.

[0054] The first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other. Therefore, there are cases where the shortest distance between the first extension portion and the second extension portion is greater than the shortest distance when the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are not formed.

[0055] According to the electrostatic chuck, the area of the first facing region can be relatively small because the third extension portion is disposed between the first extension portion and the second extension portion at a position where the third extension portion does not overlap the first and second protruding portions. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object can be increased.

[0056] A fourteenth invention is the electrostatic chuck of any one of the ninth to twelfth inventions, wherein the multiple protruding portions further include a third protruding portion that is located in the first extension portion and protrudes toward the second protruding portion; and the third protruding portion is disposed so as to face and be adjacent to the second protruding portion.

[0057] According to the electrostatic chuck, the number of cool spots in the entire plane can be relatively low by disposing a region (the second facing region) in which the second protruding portion and the third protruding portion are aggregated proximate to the first facing region. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object can be increased while suppressing complex temperature control.

[0058] A fifteenth invention is an electrostatic chuck including a ceramic dielectric substrate, a base plate supporting the ceramic dielectric substrate, and a heater unit heating the ceramic dielectric substrate; the ceramic dielectric substrate has a first major surface configured to have a process object placed thereon, and a second major surface opposite to the first major surface; the base plate has an upper surface at the ceramic dielectric substrate side and a lower surface opposite to the upper surface, and includes a coolant flow path for allowing a cooling medium to flow; the heater unit includes a first heater element, a second heater element, a bypass layer, and first to fourth power feeding terminals electrically connected to the bypass layer; the bypass layer is a power feeding path to the first and second heater elements; the first heater element is located between the first major surface and the upper surface; the second heater element is located between the first major surface and the first heater element or between the first heater element and the upper surface; the first heater element includes multiple zones; the multiple zones of the first heater element include a first zone; the first zone includes a first heater line emitting heat by allowing a current to flow, and a first power feeding portion and a second power feeding portion feeding power to the first heater line; the first power feeding portion is electrically connected to the first power feeding terminal via the bypass layer and is located at a position where the first power feeding portion does not overlap the first power feeding terminal in a Z-direction perpendicular to the first major surface; the second power feeding portion is electrically connected to the second power feeding terminal via the bypass layer and is located at a position where the second power feeding portion does not overlap the second power feeding terminal in the Z-direction; the second heater element includes multiple zones; the multiple zones of the second heater element include a second zone; the second zone includes a second heater line emitting heat by allowing a current to flow, and a third

power feeding portion and a fourth power feeding portion feeding power to the second heater line; the third power feeding portion is electrically connected to the third power feeding terminal via the bypass layer and is located at a position where the third power feeding portion does not overlap the third power feeding terminal in the Z-direction; the fourth power feeding portion is electrically connected to the fourth power feeding terminal via the bypass layer and is located at a position where the fourth power feeding portion does not overlap the fourth power feeding terminal in the Z-direction; at least one of the third power feeding terminal or the fourth power feeding terminal is located at a position where the at least one of the third power feeding terminal or the fourth power feeding terminal overlaps a virtual line segment in the Z-direction; and the virtual line segment connects a center of the first power feeding portion and a center of the second power feeding portion.

[0059] When the number of zones of the heater unit is increased to increase the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object, the number of power feeding portions and the like for feeding power to the zones is increased. The power feeding portions are likely to become cool spots. On the other hand, even when the coolant flow path for allowing the cooling medium to flow is provided inside the base plate, the coolant flow path is not provided at the position at which the power feeding terminal for feeding power to the bypass layer is located. Therefore, the position at which the power feeding terminal is located is difficult to cool compared to the other positions, and is likely to become a hotspot. In contrast, according to the electrostatic chuck, at least one of the third power feeding terminal or the fourth power feeding terminal for feeding power to the second heater element via the bypass layer is located at a position where the at least one of the third power feeding terminal or the fourth power feeding terminal overlaps a virtual line segment connecting the center of the first power feeding portion and the center of the second power feeding portion that feed power to the first heater line. Accordingly, the temperature unevenness can be canceled by providing the third and fourth power feeding terminals, i.e., the hotspots, between the first power feeding portion and the second power feeding portion, i.e., the cool spots. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object can be increased while suppressing complex temperature control.

[0060] A sixteenth invention is the electrostatic chuck of the fifteenth invention, wherein at least one of a center of the third power feeding terminal or a center of the fourth power feeding terminal is located at a position overlapping the virtual line segment.

[0061] According to the electrostatic chuck, the third power feeding terminal and the fourth power feeding terminal are located at positions such that at least one of the center of the third power feeding terminal or the center of the fourth power feeding terminal overlaps the virtual line segment. The uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object can be increased thereby.

[0062] A seventeenth invention is the electrostatic chuck of the fifteenth or the sixteenth invention, wherein the first zone includes a central region and an outer peripheral region; the central region is positioned at a center of the first zone when viewed along the Z-direction; the outer peripheral region is positioned outside the central region when viewed along the Z-direction; and at least one of the first power feeding portion or the second power feeding portion is located in the central region.

[0063] According to the electrostatic chuck, at least one of the first power feeding portion or the second power feeding portion is located in the central region, which is likely to have a higher temperature than the outer peripheral region in the first zone. Accordingly, a drastic reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots can be suppressed by disposing the first power feeding portion and/or the second power feeding portion, i.e., the cool spots, so as to overlap the central region of the first zone, i.e., the hotspot. That is, the temperature unevenness can be canceled. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object can be increased.

[0064] An eighteenth invention is the electrostatic chuck of the fifteenth or the sixteenth invention,

wherein the first zone includes an outer circumference edge of the first heater element; the first zone includes an inner circumference portion and an outer circumference portion; the inner circumference portion is positioned radially inward of a center line of a radial direction; the center line of the radial direction bisects the first zone in the radial direction; the outer circumference portion includes the outer circumference edge and is positioned radially outward of the center line of the radial direction; and at least one of the first power feeding portion or the second power feeding portion is located in the inner circumference portion.

[0065] According to the electrostatic chuck, when the first zone includes the outer circumference edge of the first heater element (i.e., the first zone is positioned at the outermost circumference portion of the first heater element), at least one of the first power feeding portion or the second power feeding portion is located in the inner circumference portion, which is likely to have a higher temperature than the outer circumference portion in the first zone. Accordingly, a drastic reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots can be suppressed by providing the first power feeding portion and/or the second power feeding portion, i.e., the cool spots, in the inner circumference portion of the first zone, i.e., the hotspot. That is, the temperature unevenness can be canceled. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object can be increased.

[0066] Hereinafter, embodiments of the invention will be described with reference to the drawings. It is noted that, in each figure, similar components are denoted by the same reference numerals, and detailed description thereof will be omitted as appropriate.

[0067] FIG. 1 is a perspective view schematically illustrating an electrostatic chuck according to an embodiment.

[0068] FIGS. 2A and 2B are cross-sectional views schematically illustrating portions of the electrostatic chuck according to the embodiment. For convenience of description in FIG. 1, a cross-sectional view is illustrated in a portion of the electrostatic chuck.

[0069] FIG. 2A is a cross-sectional view along line A1-A2 shown in FIG. 1.

[0070] FIG. 2B is an enlarged view of region B1 shown in FIG. 2A. A process object W is not illustrated in FIG. 2B.

[0071] As illustrated in FIGS. 1, 2A, and 2B, the electrostatic chuck **10** according to the embodiment includes a ceramic dielectric substrate **100**, a heater unit **200**, and a base plate **300**.

[0072] The ceramic dielectric substrate **100** is, for example, a flat plate-shaped base material made of a polycrystalline ceramic sintered body and has a first major surface **101** on which a process object W such as a semiconductor wafer is mounted and a second major surface **102** which is a side opposite to the first major surface **101**.

[0073] In the specification, the direction perpendicular to the first major surface **101** is defined as a Z-direction. In other words, the Z-direction is a direction connecting the first major surface **101** and the second major surface **102**. In other words, the Z-direction is a direction from the base plate **300** toward the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**. One of the directions orthogonal to the Z-direction is defined as an X-direction, and the direction orthogonal to the Z-direction and the X-direction is defined as a Y-direction. In the specification, “in-plane” denotes, for example, in an XY plane. In the specification, “plan view” indicates a state viewed along the Z-direction.

[0074] For example, Al.sub.2O.sub.3, AlN, SiC, Y.sub.2O.sub.3, YAG, etc., are examples of the material of the crystal included in the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**. By using such a material, the infrared transmissivity, thermal conductivity, insulation resistance, and plasma resistance of the ceramic dielectric substrate **100** can be increased.

[0075] An electrode layer **111** is provided inside the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**. The electrode layer **111** is interposed between the first major surface **101** and the second major surface **102**. That is, the electrode layer **111** is formed so as to be inserted into the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**. The electrode layer **111** is integrally sintered on the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**.

[0076] The electrode layer **111** is not limited to being interposed between the first major surface **101** and the second major surface **102**, and the electrode layer **111** may be attached to the second

major surface **102**.

[0077] The electrostatic chuck **10** generates charges on the first major surface **101** side of the electrode layer **111** by applying a clamping voltage to the electrode layer **111** and clamps the process object W by the electrostatic force.

[0078] The electrode layer **111** is provided along the first major surface **101** and the second major surface **102**. The electrode layer **111** is a clamping electrode for clamping the process object W. The electrode layer **111** may be of a unipolar type or a bipolar type. The electrode layer **111** may be of a tripolar type or of a multipolar type. The number of electrode layers **111** and the arrangement of the electrode layers **111** are appropriately selected.

[0079] The base plate **300** is located at the second major surface **102** side of the ceramic dielectric substrate **100** and supports the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**. The base plate **300** has an upper surface **302** at the ceramic dielectric substrate **100** side, and a lower surface **303** opposite to the upper surface **302**. A coolant flow path **301** for allowing a cooling medium to flow is provided in the base plate **300**. That is, the coolant flow path **301** is located inside the base plate **300**. For example, aluminum, aluminum alloys, titanium, and titanium alloys are examples of the material of the base plate **300**.

[0080] The base plate **300** performs the role of temperature adjustment of the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**. For example, when cooling the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**, a cooling medium is caused to flow into the coolant flow path **301**, pass through the coolant flow path **301**, and flow out of the coolant flow path **301**. Accordingly, the heat of the base plate **300** is absorbed by the cooling medium; and the ceramic dielectric substrate **100** mounted on the base plate **300** can be cooled.

[0081] Convex portions **113** are provided on the first major surface **101** side of the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**, as needed. Grooves **115** are provided between the adjacent convex portions **113**. The grooves **115** communicate with each other. A space is formed between the grooves **115** and a back side of the process object W mounted on the electrostatic chuck **10**.

[0082] An introduction path **321** penetrating the base plate **300** and the ceramic dielectric substrate **100** is connected to the groove **115**. When a transfer gas such as helium (He) is introduced from the introduction path **321** in a state where the process object W is clamped and held, the transfer gas flows into the space provided between the process object W and the groove **115**, and the process object W can be directly heated or cooled by the transfer gas.

[0083] The heater unit **200** heats the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**. The heater unit **200** heats the process object W via the ceramic dielectric substrate **100** by heating the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**. In the example, the heater unit **200** is located between the first major surface **101** and the second major surface **102**. In other words, the heater unit **200** is formed so as to be inserted into the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**. In other words, the heater unit **200** is embedded in the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**.

[0084] The heater unit **200** may be located separately from the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**. In such a case, for example, the heater unit **200** is located between the ceramic dielectric substrate **100** and the base plate **300** with an adhesive layer interposed. A heat-resistant resin that has a relatively high thermal conductivity such as silicone or the like is an example of the material of the adhesive layer.

[0085] FIG. **3** is an exploded perspective view schematically illustrating the heater unit according to the embodiment.

[0086] FIG. **4** is an exploded cross-sectional view schematically illustrating the heater unit according to the embodiment.

[0087] In the example as illustrated in FIGS. **3** and **4**, the heater unit **200** includes a first support plate **210**, a first insulating layer **220**, a sub-heater element **231**, a second insulating layer **240**, a main heater element **232**, a third insulating layer **245**, a bypass layer **250**, a fourth insulating layer **260**, a second support plate **270**, and a power feeding terminal **280**.

[0088] The first support plate **210** is located on the sub-heater element **231**, the main heater

element **232**, the bypass layer **250**, etc. The second support plate **270** is located under the sub-heater element **231**, the main heater element **232**, the bypass layer **250**, etc. A surface **211** (the upper surface) of the first support plate **210** is the upper surface of the heater unit **200**. A surface **271** (the lower surface) of the second support plate **270** is the lower surface of the heater unit **200**. When the heater unit **200** is embedded in the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**, the first support plate **210** and the second support plate **270** may be omitted.

[0089] The first support plate **210** and the second support plate **270** are support plates supporting the sub-heater element **231**, the main heater element **232**, etc. In the example, the first support plate **210** and the second support plate **270** support the first insulating layer **220**, the sub-heater element **231**, the second insulating layer **240**, the main heater element **232**, the third insulating layer **245**, the bypass layer **250**, and the fourth insulating layer **260** with these components interposed.

[0090] The first insulating layer **220** is located between the first support plate **210** and the second support plate **270**. The sub-heater element **231** is located between the first insulating layer **220** and the second support plate **270**. Thus, the sub-heater element **231** is provided so as to overlap the first support plate **210**. In other words, the first insulating layer **220** is located between the first support plate **210** and the sub-heater element **231**. When the heater unit **200** is embedded in the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**, the ceramic dielectric substrate **100** also serves as the first insulating layer **220**.

[0091] The second insulating layer **240** is located between the sub-heater element **231** and the second support plate **270**. The main heater element **232** is located between the second insulating layer **240** and the second support plate **270**. Thus, the main heater element **232** is located in a different layer from the layer in which the sub-heater element **231** is located. At least a portion of the main heater element **232** overlaps the sub-heater element **231** in the Z-direction. The third insulating layer **245** is located between the main heater element **232** and the second support plate **270**. The bypass layer **250** is located between the third insulating layer **245** and the second support plate **270**. The fourth insulating layer **260** is located between the bypass layer **250** and the second support plate **270**.

[0092] In other words, the sub-heater element **231** is located between the first insulating layer **220** and the second insulating layer **240**. In other words, the main heater element **232** is located between the second insulating layer **240** and the third insulating layer **245**. In other words, the bypass layer **250** is located between the third insulating layer **245** and the fourth insulating layer **260**.

[0093] For example, the sub-heater element **231** contacts the first and second insulating layers **220** and **240**. For example, the main heater element **232** contacts the second and third insulating layers **240** and **245**. For example, the bypass layer **250** contacts the third and fourth insulating layers **245** and **260**.

[0094] The bypass layer **250** and the fourth insulating layer **260** are provided as necessary and can be omitted. When the bypass layer **250** and the fourth insulating layer **260** are not provided, the third insulating layer **245** is in contact with the second support plate **270**. Hereinafter, a case where the heater unit **200** includes the bypass layer **250** and the fourth insulating layer **260** will be described as an example.

[0095] The first support plate **210** has a relatively high thermal conductivity. For example, the thermal conductivity of the first support plate **210** is greater than the thermal conductivity of the sub-heater element **231** and greater than the thermal conductivity of the main heater element **232**. For example, a metal that includes at least one of aluminum, copper, or nickel, graphite that has a multilayer structure, etc., are examples of the material of the first support plate **210**. The thickness (the Z-direction length) of the first support plate **210** is, for example, not less than about 0.1 mm and not more than about 3.0 mm. More favorably, the thickness of the first support plate **210** is, for example, not less than about 0.3 mm and not more than about 1.0 mm. The first support plate **210** increases the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the heater unit **200**. For example, the first support plate **210** functions as a soaking plate. The first support plate **210**

suppresses the warp of the heater unit **200**. The first support plate **210** increases the bonding strength between the heater unit **200** and the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**.

[0096] The material, thickness, and function of the second support plate **270** are respectively the same as the material, thickness, and function of the first support plate **210**. For example, the thermal conductivity of the second support plate **270** is greater than the thermal conductivity of the sub-heater element **231** and greater than the thermal conductivity of the main heater element **232**. According to the embodiment, at least one of the first support plate **210** or the second support plate **270** may be omitted.

[0097] For example, an insulating material such as a resin, a ceramic, etc., can be used as the material of the first insulating layer **220**. Polyimide, polyamideimide, etc., are examples when the first insulating layer **220** is a resin. Al.sub.2O.sub.3, AlN, SiC, Y.sub.2O.sub.3, YAG, etc., are examples when the first insulating layer **220** is a ceramic. The thickness (the Z-direction length) of the first insulating layer **220** is, for example, not less than about 0.01 mm and not more than about 0.20 mm. The first insulating layer **220** bonds the first support plate **210** and the sub-heater element **231**. The first insulating layer **220** electrically insulates between the first support plate **210** and the sub-heater element **231**. Thus, the first insulating layer **220** has an electrical insulation function and a surface bonding function. It is sufficient for the first insulating layer **220** to have at least an insulation function; and the first insulating layer **220** may have other functions such as, for example, a heat conduction function, a diffusion prevention function, etc.

[0098] The material and thickness of the second insulating layer **240** are about the same as the material and thickness of the first insulating layer **220**, respectively. The material and thickness of the third insulating layer **245** are about the same as the material and thickness of the first insulating layer **220**, respectively. The material and thickness of the fourth insulating layer **260** are about the same as the material and thickness of the first insulating layer **220**, respectively.

[0099] The second insulating layer **240** bonds the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232**. The second insulating layer **240** electrically insulates between the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232**. Thus, the second insulating layer **240** has an electrical insulation function and a surface bonding function. It is sufficient for the second insulating layer **240** to have at least an insulation function; and the second insulating layer **240** may have other functions such as, for example, a heat conduction function, a diffusion prevention function, etc.

[0100] The third insulating layer **245** bonds the main heater element **232** and the bypass layer **250**. The third insulating layer **245** electrically insulates between the main heater element **232** and the bypass layer **250**. Thus, the third insulating layer **245** has an electrical insulation function and a surface bonding function. It is sufficient for the third insulating layer **245** to have at least an insulation function; and the third insulating layer **245** may have other functions such as, for example, a heat conduction function, a diffusion prevention function, etc.

[0101] The fourth insulating layer **260** bonds the bypass layer **250** and the second support plate **270**. The fourth insulating layer **260** electrically insulates between the bypass layer **250** and the second support plate **270**. Thus, the fourth insulating layer **260** has the electrical insulation function and the surface bonding function. The fourth insulating layer **260** may have at least an insulation function and may have other functions such as a heat conduction function and a diffusion prevention function.

[0102] When the sub-heater element **231** is located inside the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**, for example, metals including at least one of titanium, chrome, nickel, copper, aluminum, molybdenum, tungsten, palladium, platinum, silver, tantalum, molybdenum carbide, or tungsten carbide, etc., are examples of the material of the sub-heater element **231**. It is favorable for the material of the sub-heater element **231** to include a ceramic material and such a metal. Aluminum oxide (Al.sub.2O.sub.3), yttrium oxide (Y.sub.2O.sub.3), yttrium aluminum garnet (YAG (Y.sub.3Al.sub.5O.sub.12)), aluminum nitride (AlN), silicon carbide (SiC), etc., are examples of ceramic materials. It is favorable for the ceramic material included in the sub-heater element **231** to

be the same as the components of the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**. When the sub-heater element **231** is located outside the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**, for example, metals including at least one of stainless steel, titanium, chrome, nickel, copper, aluminum, Inconel (registered trademark), molybdenum, tungsten, palladium, platinum, silver, tantalum, molybdenum carbide, or tungsten carbide, etc., are examples of the material of the sub-heater element **231**. The thickness (the Z-direction length) of the sub-heater element **231** is, for example, not less than about 0.01 mm and not more than about 0.20 mm. The material and thickness of the main heater element **232** are respectively similar to the material and thickness of the sub-heater element **231**. For example, when the main heater element **232** is located inside the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**, the same materials as the materials of the sub-heater element **231** when the sub-heater element **231** is located inside the ceramic dielectric substrate **100** are examples of the material of the main heater element **232**. For example, when the main heater element **232** is located outside the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**, the same materials as the materials of the sub-heater element **231** when the sub-heater element **231** is located outside the ceramic dielectric substrate **100** are examples of the material of the main heater element **232**. For example, the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232** each are electrically connected to the bypass layer **250**. On the other hand, the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232** each are electrically insulated from the first support plate **210** and the second support plate **270**.

[0103] The sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232** each generate heat when a current flows. The sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232** heat the ceramic dielectric substrate **100** by emitting heat. For example, the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232** make the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object W uniform by heating the process object W via the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**. Or, for example, the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232** also can intentionally cause a difference in the in-plane temperature of the process object W by heating the process object W via the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**.

[0104] The bypass layer **250** is disposed substantially parallel to the first support plate **210** and substantially parallel to the second support plate **270**. The bypass layer **250** includes multiple bypass portions **251**. In the example, the bypass layer **250** includes ten bypass portions **251** (bypass portions **251a** to **251j**). The number of the bypass portions **251** is not limited to “ten”. The bypass layer **250** has a plate shape.

[0105] The bypass layer **250** is, for example, electrically conductive. For example, the bypass layer **250** is electrically connected to the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232**. The bypass layer **250** is a power feeding path of the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232**. On the other hand, for example, the bypass layer **250** is electrically insulated from the first support plate **210** and the second support plate **270** by an insulating layer.

[0106] The thickness (length in the Z-direction) of the bypass layer **250** is, for example, not less than about 0.03 mm and not more than about 0.30 mm. The thickness of the bypass layer **250** is larger than that of the first insulating layer **220**. The thickness of the bypass layer **250** is larger than that of the second insulating layer **240**. The thickness of the bypass layer **250** is larger than that of the third insulating layer **245**. The thickness of the bypass layer **250** is larger than that of the fourth insulating layer **260**.

[0107] For example, when the bypass layer **250** is located outside the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**, metals including at least one of stainless steel, titanium, chrome, nickel, copper, aluminum, Inconel (registered trademark), molybdenum, tungsten, palladium, platinum, silver, tantalum, molybdenum carbide, or tungsten carbide, etc., are examples of the material of the bypass layer **250**. For example, when the heater unit **200** (the bypass layer **250**, the sub-heater element **231**, and the main heater element **232**) is located inside the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**, the material of the bypass layer **250** is the same as the material of the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232**. On the other hand, the thickness of the bypass layer **250** is greater than the thickness

of the sub-heater element **231** and greater than the thickness of the main heater element **232**. Therefore, the electrical resistance of the bypass layer **250** is less than the electrical resistance of the sub-heater element **231** and less than the electrical resistance of the main heater element **232**. Heat generation by the bypass layer **250** in the manner of the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232** can be suppressed thereby, even when the material of the bypass layer **250** is the same as the material of the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232**. That is, the electrical resistance of the bypass layer **250** can be reduced, and the generated heat amount of the bypass layer **250** can be reduced.

[0108] The technique of reducing the electrical resistance of the bypass layer **250** and reducing the generated heat amount of the bypass layer **250** may be realized by using a material having a relatively low volume resistivity instead of using the thickness of the bypass layer **250**. In other words, the material of the bypass layer **250** may be a different material from the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232**. For example, metals including at least one of stainless steel, titanium, chrome, nickel, copper, aluminum, Inconel (registered trademark), molybdenum, tungsten, palladium, platinum, silver, tantalum, molybdenum carbide, or tungsten carbide, etc., are examples of the material of the bypass layer **250**.

[0109] For example, when the bypass layer **250** is located inside the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**, the same materials as the materials of the sub-heater element **231** when the sub-heater element **231** is located inside the ceramic dielectric substrate **100** are examples of the material of the bypass layer **250**. For example, when the bypass layer **250** is located outside the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**, the same materials as the materials of the sub-heater element **231** when the sub-heater element **231** is located outside the ceramic dielectric substrate **100** are examples of the material of the bypass layer **250**.

[0110] The power feeding terminals **280** are electrically connected to the bypass layer **250**. The power feeding terminals **280** are provided from the heater unit **200** toward the base plate **300** in the state in which the heater unit **200** is located between the base plate **300** and the ceramic dielectric substrate **100**. The power feeding terminals **280** supply the power supplied from outside an electrostatic chuck **10** to the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232** via the bypass layer **250**. For example, the power feeding terminals **280** may be directly connected to the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232**. The bypass layer **250** is omissible thereby.

[0111] On the other hand, when the sub-heater element **231** and/or the main heater element **232** includes many zones, e.g., not less than 20, not less than 50, or not less than 100, it is difficult to dispose the power feeding terminals **280** corresponding to each zone. By providing the bypass layer **250**, the layout degree of freedom of the power feeding terminals **280** is increased compared to when the power feeding terminals **280** are disposed for each zone.

[0112] The heater unit **200** includes multiple power feeding terminals **280**. In the example, the heater unit **200** includes ten power feeding terminals **280** (power feeding terminals **280a** to **280j**). The number of the power feeding terminals **280** is not limited to “ten”. One power feeding terminal **280** is electrically connected to one bypass portion **251**. That is, the number of the power feeding terminals **280** is equal to the number of the bypass portions **251**. A hole **273** penetrates the second support plate **270**. The power feeding terminal **280** is electrically connected to the bypass portion **251** through the hole **273**.

[0113] The sub-heater element **231** includes a first region **701** and a second region **702**. Each of the first and second regions **701** and **702** includes a first sub-power feeding portion **231a**, a second sub-power feeding portion **231b**, and a sub-heater line **231c**. The sub-heater line **231c** is electrically connected to the first and second sub-power feeding portions **231a** and **231b**. The first sub-power feeding portion **231a** is located at one end of the sub-heater line **231c**; and the second sub-power feeding portion **231b** is located at the other end of the sub-heater line **231c**. The sub-heater line **231c** generates heat by allowing a current to flow. The first sub-power feeding portion **231a** and the

second sub-power feeding portion **231b** feed power to the sub-heater line **231c**. The sub-heater element **231** is electrically connected to the bypass layer **250** at the first and second sub-power feeding portions **231a** and **231b**.

[0114] When power is supplied from outside the electrostatic chuck **10** to the power feeding terminal **280a** as indicated by arrows C21 and C22 illustrated in FIG. 4, the current flows from the power feeding terminal **280a** to the bypass portion **251a**. As indicated by arrows C23 and C24 illustrated in FIG. 4, the current flowing to the bypass portion **251a** flows from the bypass portion **251a** to the first region **701** of the sub-heater element **231**. As indicated by arrows C25 and C26 illustrated in FIG. 4, the current flowing to the first region **701** flows from the first region **701** to a bypass portion **251b**. More specifically, the current flowing to the bypass portion **251a** flows to the sub-heater line **231c** of the first region **701** via the first sub-power feeding portion **231a** of the first region **701**, and flows to the bypass portion **251b** via the second sub-power feeding portion **231b** of the first region **701**. As indicated by arrows C27 and C28 illustrated in FIG. 4, the current flowing to the bypass portion **251b** flows from the bypass portion **251b** to the power feeding terminal **280b**. As indicated by arrow C29 illustrated in FIG. 4, the current flowing to the power feeding terminal **280b** flows outside the electrostatic chuck **10**.

[0115] Similarly, when power is supplied to the power feeding terminal **280c** from outside the electrostatic chuck **10**, the current flows in the order of the power feeding terminal **280c**, the bypass portion **251c**, the second region **702** of the sub-heater element **231**, the bypass portion **251d**, and the power feeding terminal **280d** as indicated by arrows C31 to C39 illustrated in FIG. 4.

[0116] The main heater element **232** includes a main zone **601**, a main zone **602**, and a main zone **603**. Each of the main zones **601** to **603** includes a first main power feeding portion **232a**, a second main power feeding portion **232b**, and a main heater line **232c**. The main heater line **232c** is electrically connected to the first and second main power feeding portions **232a** and **232b**. The first main power feeding portion **232a** is located at one end of the main heater line **232c**; and the second main power feeding portion **232b** is located at the other end of the main heater line **232c**. The main heater line **232c** generates heat by allowing a current to flow. The first main power feeding portion **232a** and the second main power feeding portion **232b** feed power to the main heater line **232c**. The main heater element **232** is electrically connected to the bypass layer **250** at the first and second main power feeding portions **232a** and **232b**.

[0117] As indicated by arrows C41 and C42 illustrated in FIG. 4, when power is supplied from outside the electrostatic chuck **10** to the power feeding terminal **280e**, the current flows from the power feeding terminal **280e** to the bypass portion **251e**. As indicated by arrows C43 and C44 illustrated in FIG. 4, the current flowing to the bypass portion **251e** flows from the bypass portion **251e** to the main zone **601** of the main heater element **232**. As indicated by arrows C45 and C46 illustrated in FIG. 4, the current flowing to the main zone **601** flows from the main zone **601** to the bypass portion **251f**. More specifically, the current flowing to the bypass portion **251e** flows to the main heater line **232c** of the main zone **601** via the first main power feeding portion **232a** of the main zone **601**, and flows to the bypass portion **251f** via the second main power feeding portion **232b** of the main zone **601**. As indicated by arrows C47 and C48 illustrated in FIG. 4, the current flowing to the bypass portion **251f** flows to the power feeding terminal **280f** from the bypass portion **251f**. As indicated by arrow C49 illustrated in FIG. 4, the current flowing to the power feeding terminal **280f** flows outside the electrostatic chuck **10**.

[0118] Similarly, when power is supplied from outside the electrostatic chuck **10** to the power feeding terminal **280g**, the current flows in the order of the power feeding terminal **280g**, the bypass portion **251g**, the main zone **602** of the main heater element **232**, the bypass portion **251h**, and the power feeding terminal **280h** as indicated by arrows C51 to C59.

[0119] Similarly, when power is supplied from outside the electrostatic chuck **10** to the power feeding terminal **280i**, the current flows in the order of the power feeding terminal **280i**, the bypass portion **251i**, the main zone **603** of the main heater element **232**, the bypass portion **251j**, and the

power feeding terminal **280j** as indicated by arrows C61 to C69.

[0120] For example, the current flowing in the sub-heater element **231** and the current flowing in the main heater element **232** are separately controlled. In the example, the bypass portions **251** (the bypass portions **251a**, **251b**, **251c**, and **251d**) connected to the sub-heater element **231** and the bypass portions **251** (the bypass portions **251e**, **251f**, **251g**, **251h**, **251i**, and **251j**) connected to the main heater element **232** are different from each other. The bypass portions **251** connected to the sub-heater element **231** and the bypass portions **251** connected to the main heater element **232** may be the same.

[0121] For example, the output of the sub-heater element **231** and the output of the main heater element **232** can be set to be different from each other by setting the voltage applied to the power feeding terminals **280** (the power feeding terminals **280a**, **280b**, **280c**, and **280d**) feeding power to the sub-heater element **231** and the voltage applied to the power feeding terminals **280** (the power feeding terminals **280e**, **280f**, **280g**, **280h**, **280i**, and **280j**) feeding power to the main heater element **232** to be different from each other. That is, the outputs of the heater elements can be controlled independently.

[0122] For example, the current flowing in the first region **701** of the sub-heater element **231** and the current flowing in the second region **702** are separately controlled. In the example, the bypass portions **251** (the bypass portions **251a** and **251b**) connected to the first region **701** and the bypass portions **251** (the bypass portions **251c** and **251d**) connected to the second region **702** are different from each other. The bypass portions **251** connected to the first region **701** and the bypass portions **251** connected to the second region **702** may be the same.

[0123] For example, the output of the first region **701** and the output of the second region **702** can be set to be different from each other by setting the voltage applied to the power feeding terminals **280** (the power feeding terminals **280a** and **280b**) feeding power to the first region **701** and the voltage applied to the power feeding terminals **280** (the power feeding terminals **280c** and **280d**) feeding power to the second region **702** to be different from each other. That is, the outputs of the regions (the sub-zones) can be controlled independently.

[0124] For example, the current flowing in the main zone **601** of the main heater element **232**, the current flowing in the main zone **602**, and the current flowing in the main zone **603** are separately controlled. In the example, the bypass portions **251** (the bypass portions **251e** and **251f**) connected to the main zone **601**, the bypass portions **251** (the bypass portions **251g** and **251h**) connected to the main zone **602**, and the bypass portions **251** (the bypass portions **251i** and **251j**) connected to the main zone **603** are different from each other. The bypass portions **251** connected to the main zone **601**, the bypass portions **251** connected to the main zone **602**, and the bypass portions **251** connected to the main zone **603** may be the same.

[0125] For example, the output of the main zone **601**, the output of the main zone **602**, and the output of the main zone **603** can be set to be different from each other by setting the voltage applied to the power feeding terminals **280** (the power feeding terminals **280e** and **280f**) feeding power to the main zone **601**, the voltage applied to the power feeding terminals **280** (the power feeding terminals **280g** and **280h**) feeding power to the main zone **602**, and the voltage applied to the power feeding terminals **280** (the power feeding terminals **280i** and **280j**) feeding power to the main zone **603** to be different from each other. That is, the outputs of the main zones can be controlled independently.

[0126] The sub-heater element **231** generates less heat than the main heater element **232**. In other words, the sub-heater element **231** is a low-output sub-heater; and the main heater element **232** is a high-output main heater.

[0127] Thus, the in-plane temperature unevenness of the process object W caused by the pattern of the main heater element **232** can be suppressed by the sub-heater element **231** by the sub-heater element **231** generating less heat than the main heater element **232**. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object W can be increased.

[0128] The volume resistivity of the sub-heater element **231** is, for example, greater than the volume resistivity of the main heater element **232**. The volume resistivity of the sub-heater element **231** is the volume resistivity of the sub-heater line **231c**. That is, the volume resistivity of the sub-heater element **231** is the volume resistivity between the first sub-power feeding portion **231a** and the second sub-power feeding portion **231b**. In other words, the volume resistivity of the sub-heater element **231** is the volume resistivity of the path indicated by arrows C25 and C35 in FIG. 4.

Similarly, the volume resistivity of the main heater element **232** is the volume resistivity of the main heater line **232c**. That is, the volume resistivity of the main heater element **232** is the volume resistivity between the first main power feeding portion **232a** and the second main power feeding portion **232b**. In other words, the volume resistivity of the main heater element **232** is the volume resistivity of the path indicated by arrow C45, arrow C55, and arrow C65 in FIG. 4.

[0129] Thus, the output (generated heat amount, power consumption) of the sub-heater element **231** can be set to be less than the output (generated heat amount, power consumption) of the main heater element **232** by setting the volume resistivity of the sub-heater element **231** to be greater than the volume resistivity of the main heater element **232**. Accordingly, the in-plane temperature unevenness of the process object W caused by the pattern of the main heater element **232** can be suppressed by the sub-heater element **231**. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object can be increased.

[0130] Temperature singularities (points where the temperatures are relatively significantly different from the surrounding regions) tend to occur around the power feeding terminals **280**. In contrast, by providing the bypass layer **250**, the degree of freedom in arranging the power feeding terminals **280** can be increased. For example, the power feeding terminals **280** that tend to have temperature singularities can be arranged in a dispersed manner, so that the heat is easily diffused around the singularities. The uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object W can be increased thereby.

[0131] A configuration in which the power feeding terminal **280** that has a large heat capacity is not directly connected to the sub-heater element **231** or the main heater element **232** is possible by providing the bypass layer **250**. The uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object W can be increased thereby. By providing the bypass layer **250**, it is unnecessary to directly connect the power feeding terminals **280** to the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232** that are relatively thin. The reliability of the heater unit **200** can be increased thereby.

[0132] As described above, the power feeding terminal **280** is provided from the heater unit **200** toward the base plate **300**. For this reason, power can be supplied from the side of the lower surface **303** (see to FIGS. 2A and 2B) of the base plate **300** to the power feeding terminal **280** via a member called a socket or the like. Accordingly, the wiring of the heater is implemented while suppressing the power feeding terminal **280** from being exposed in the chamber in which the electrostatic chuck **10** is installed.

[0133] In the example, the sub-heater element **231** is positioned higher than the main heater element **232**. In other words, the sub-heater element **231** is located between the main heater element **232** and the first major surface **101**. The position of the sub-heater element **231** and the position of the main heater element **232** may be reversed. That is, the main heater element **232** may be positioned higher than the sub-heater element **231**. In other words, the main heater element **232** may be located between the first major surface **101** and the sub-heater element **231**. From the perspective of temperature control, it is favorable for the sub-heater element **231** to be positioned higher than the main heater element **232**.

[0134] When the sub-heater element **231** is positioned higher than the main heater element **232**, the distance between the sub-heater element **231** and the process object W is less than the distance between the main heater element **232** and the process object W. By providing the sub-heater element **231** relatively proximate to the process object W, the temperature of the process object W is more easily controlled by the sub-heater element **231**. In other words, the in-plane temperature

unevenness of the process object W caused by the pattern of the main heater element **232** is more easily suppressed by the sub-heater element **231**. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object W can be increased.

[0135] On the other hand, when the main heater element **232** is positioned higher than the sub-heater element **231**, the high-output main heater element **232** is relatively proximate to the process object W. The responsiveness (the temperature raising rate/temperature lowering rate) of the temperature of the process object W can be improved thereby.

[0136] In the example, the main heater element **232** is located between the bypass layer **250** and the sub-heater element **231** in the Z-direction. That is, the bypass layer **250** is positioned lower than the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232**.

[0137] Thus, the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232** can be disposed at one side of the bypass layer **250** by providing the main heater element **232** between the bypass layer **250** and the sub-heater element **231** in the Z-direction. Accordingly, when connecting the power feeding terminal **280** to the bypass layer **250**, the power feeding terminal **280** can be connected to the bypass layer **250** from the side opposite to the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232**. Accordingly, it is unnecessary to provide a hole part for passing the power feeding terminal **280** in the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232**; temperature singularities in the heater pattern can be reduced; and the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distributions of the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232** can be increased.

[0138] The bypass layer **250** may be positioned higher than the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232**. That is, the bypass layer **250** may be located between the first support plate **210** and the sub-heater element **231**. The bypass layer **250** may be located between the first support plate **210** and the main heater element **232**. The bypass layer **250** may be positioned between the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232**.

[0139] The number of heater elements included in the heater unit **200** is not limited to “two”. That is, the heater unit **200** may further include another heater element located in a different layer from the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232**. The heater unit **200** may include only one of the sub-heater element **231** or the main heater element **232**. That is, one of the sub-heater element **231** or the main heater element **232** may be omitted.

[0140] FIG. 5 is a plan view schematically illustrating main zones of the main heater element according to the embodiment.

[0141] FIG. 5 is a view in which the main heater element **232** according to FIG. 3 is projected onto a plane perpendicular to the Z-direction.

[0142] As illustrated in FIG. 5, the main heater element **232** includes multiple main zones **600** divided in a radial direction Dr. In the main heater element **232**, for example, independent temperature control is performed in each of the main zones **600**.

[0143] In this specification, the “radial direction Dr” is a direction from the center of the heater element toward the outer circumference along a radius. A “circumferential direction Dc” is a direction along the outer circumference of the heater element.

[0144] In the example, the multiple main zones **600** include the three main zones **601** to **603** arranged in the radial direction Dr. That is, the main heater element **232** is divided into three zones in the radial direction Dr. The main zones **600** are arranged in the order of the main zone **601**, the main zone **602**, and the main zone **603** from a center CT2 of the main heater element **232** outward in the radial direction Dr.

[0145] In the example, the main zone **601** has a circular shape centered on the center CT2 when viewed in plan. The main zone **602** has an annular shape centered on the center CT2 positioned outside the main zone **601** when viewed in plan. The main zone **603** has an annular shape centered on the center CT2 positioned outside the main zone **602** when viewed in plan.

[0146] In the example, a width LM1 of the main zone **601** in the radial direction Dr, a width LM2 of the main zone **602** in the radial direction Dr, and a width LM3 of the main zone **603** in the radial

direction Dr are the same as each other. The widths LM1 to LM3 may be different from each other. [0147] The number of the main zones **600** and the shape of the main zone **600** when viewed in plan may be arbitrary. The main zone **600** may be divided in the circumferential direction Dc, or may be divided in the circumferential direction Dc and the radial direction Dr.

[0148] The main heater lines **232c** that are included in the main zones **600** are independent of each other. Accordingly, a different voltage can be applied to each main zone **600** (main heater line **232c**). Accordingly, the output (the generated heat amount) can be controlled independently for each main zone **600**. In other words, the main zones **600** are heater units capable of mutually-independent temperature control; and the main heater element **232** is an aggregate of heater units including multiple heater units.

[0149] As described above, each main zone **600** includes one first main power feeding portion **232a**, one second main power feeding portion **232b**, and one main heater line **232c**. The main heater line **232c** is one electrode connecting the first and second main power feeding portions **232a** and **232b**, and generates heat by allowing a current to flow. The main zone **600** is a region that includes the continuous main heater line **232c** connecting the first and second main power feeding portions **232a** and **232b**.

[0150] For convenience in FIG. 5, the end portions in the radial direction Dr of the main zones **600** are shown as being in contact with each other, but actually, a gap (i.e., a portion where the main heater line **232c** is not provided) exists between the end portions; and the end portions in the radial direction Dr of adjacent main zones do not contact each other. This is the same for the following figures.

[0151] FIG. 6 is a plan view schematically illustrating sub-zones of the sub-heater element according to the embodiment.

[0152] FIG. 6 is a view in which the sub-heater element **231** according to FIG. 3 is projected onto a plane perpendicular to the Z-direction.

[0153] In the example as illustrated in FIG. 6, the sub-heater element **231** includes multiple sub-zones **700** divided in the radial direction Dr and the circumferential direction Dc. In the sub-heater element **231**, independent temperature control is performed in each sub-zone **700**.

[0154] The multiple sub-zones **700** include the first region **701** made of sub-zones **701a** to **701f** arranged in the circumferential direction Dc, and the second region **702** made of sub-zones **702a** to **702f** arranged in the circumferential direction Dc. That is, the main heater element **232** is divided into two zones in the radial direction Dr. The first region **701** and the second region **702** each are divided into six zones in the circumferential direction Dc. The regions are arranged in the order of the first region **701** and the second region **702** from a center CT1 of the sub-heater element **231** outward in the radial direction Dr.

[0155] The first region **701** has a circular shape centered on the center CT1 in a plan view. The second region **702** has an annular shape located outside the first region **701** and centered on the center CT1 in a plan view.

[0156] The first region **701** has the sub-zones **701a** to **701f**. In the first region **701**, the sub-zones **701a** to **701f** are disposed clockwise in the order of the sub-zone **701a**, the sub-zone **701b**, the sub-zone **701c**, the sub-zone **701d**, the sub-zone **701e**, and the sub-zone **701f**. Each of the sub-zones **701a** to **701f** is a portion of the circular first region **701**.

[0157] The second region **702** has the sub-zones **702a** to **702f**. In the second region **702**, the sub-zones **702a** to **702f** are disposed clockwise in the order of the sub-zone **702a**, the sub-zone **702b**, the sub-zone **702c**, the sub-zone **702d**, the sub-zone **702e**, and the sub-zone **702f**. In the example, the sub-zone **702a** is located outside the sub-zone **701a**. The sub-zone **702b** is located outside the sub-zone **701b**. The sub-zone **702c** is located outside the sub-zone **701c**. The sub-zone **702d** is located outside the sub-zone **701d**. The sub-zone **702e** is located outside the sub-zone **701e**. The sub-zone **702f** is located outside the sub-zone **701f**. Each of the sub-zones **702a** to **702f** is a portion of the annular second region **702**.

[0158] A width LS1 in the radial direction Dr of the first region **701** and a width LS2 in the radial direction Dr of the second region **702** are, for example, the same. The width LS1 and the width LS2 may be different from each other.

[0159] The number of the multiple sub-zones **700** is, for example, greater than the number of the multiple main zones **600**. That is, for example, the sub-heater element **231** is divided into more zones than the main heater element **232**. The number of the multiple sub-zones **700** may be equal to the number of the multiple main zones **600** or less than the number of the multiple main zones **600**.

[0160] By setting the number of the multiple sub-zones **700** included in the sub-heater element **231** to be greater than the number of the multiple main zones **600** included in the main heater element **232**, the sub-heater element **231** can perform temperature adjustment of narrower regions than the main heater element **232**. Finer temperature adjustment by the sub-heater element **231** is possible thereby, and the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object W can be increased.

[0161] The number of the sub-zones **700** and the shape of the sub-zone **700** when viewed in plan may be arbitrary. The sub-zone **700** may not be divided in the circumferential direction Dc. That is, the first region **701** and the second region **702** may not include the multiple sub-zones **700** divided in the circumferential direction Dc.

[0162] The sub-heater lines **231c** included in the sub-zones **700** are independent of each other. Accordingly, a different voltage can be applied to each sub-zone **700** (sub-heater line **231c**). Accordingly, the output (the generated heat amount) can be controlled independently for each sub-zone **700**. In other words, the sub-zones **700** are heater units capable of performing mutually-independent temperature control; and the sub-heater element **231** is an aggregate of heater units including multiple heater units.

[0163] As described above, each sub-zone **700** includes one first sub-power feeding portion **231a**, one second sub-power feeding portion **231b**, and one sub-heater line **231c**. The sub-heater line **231c** is one electrode connecting the first sub-power feeding portion **231a** and the second sub-power feeding portion **231b** and generates heat by allowing a current to flow. The sub-zone **700** is a region including the continuous sub-heater line **231c** that connects the first sub-power feeding portion **231a** and the second sub-power feeding portion **231b**.

[0164] For convenience in FIG. **6**, the end portions in the radial direction Dr of the sub-zones **700** are shown as being in contact with each other, but actually, a gap (i.e., a portion where the sub-heater line **231c** is not provided) exists between the end portions; and the end portions in the radial direction Dr of the adjacent sub-zones **700** do not contact each other. This is the same for the following figures.

[0165] FIG. **7** is a plan view schematically illustrating the positional relationship between the main zones of the main heater element and the sub-zones of the sub-heater element according to the embodiment.

[0166] FIG. **7** shows the positional relationship when viewed along the Z-direction when the main heater element **232** illustrated in FIG. **5** and the sub-heater element **231** illustrated in FIG. **6** are overlaid.

[0167] In FIG. **7**, the main zones **600** of the main heater element **232** are illustrated by double dot-dash lines, and the sub-zones **700** of the sub-heater element **231** are illustrated by solid lines.

[0168] As illustrated in FIG. **7**, the sub-heater element **231** and the main heater element **232** are disposed so that, for example, the center CT1 of the sub-heater element **231** and the center CT2 of the main heater element **232** overlap in the Z-direction. For example, an outer circumference edge **231e** of the sub-heater element **231** and an outer circumference edge **232e** of the main heater element **232** also overlap in the Z-direction. The outer circumference edge **231e** of the sub-heater element **231** and the outer circumference edge **232e** of the main heater element **232** may not overlap in the Z-direction.

[0169] FIG. **8** is a plan view schematically illustrating a portion of the first zone of the heater unit

according to the embodiment.

[0170] FIG. 8 illustrates an enlarged portion of a first zone **810** of the heater unit **200**. The first zone **810** is one of multiple zones included in the first heater element of the heater unit **200**. The first heater element may be the sub-heater element **231** or may be the main heater element **232**. That is, the first zone **810** may be one of the sub-zones **700** of the sub-heater element **231** or one of the main zones **600** of the main heater element **232**.

[0171] As illustrated in FIG. 8, the first zone **810** includes a first heater line **833**. The first zone **810** further includes a first power feeding portion **831** (see FIGS. 13 to 16) and a second power feeding portion **832** (see FIGS. 13 to 16). The first heater line **833** generates heat by allowing a current to flow. The first power feeding portion **831** and the second power feeding portion **832** feed power to the first heater line **833**.

[0172] When the first zone **810** is one of the sub-zones **700**, the first power feeding portion **831**, the second power feeding portion **832**, and the first heater line **833** are respectively the first sub-power feeding portion **231a**, the second sub-power feeding portion **231b**, and the sub-heater line **231c**. When the first zone **810** is one of the main zones **600**, the first power feeding portion **831**, the second power feeding portion **832**, and the first heater line **833** are respectively the first main power feeding portion **232a**, the second main power feeding portion **232b**, and the main heater line **232c**.

[0173] The first heater line **833** includes multiple extension portions **834** and a folded portion **835** (see FIGS. 13 to 16). The first heater line **833** has a structure in which the multiple extension portions **834** are connected by the folded portion **835**. Accordingly, the first heater line **833** functions as one electrode connecting the first power feeding portion **831** and the second power feeding portion **832**. The first heater line **833** includes multiple protruding portions **836** provided in the multiple extension portions **834**. The protruding portion **836** is bent from the extension portion **834** extending along the first direction and extends in the second direction. The thickness of the first heater line **833** at the protruding portion **836** is, for example, equal to the thickness of the first heater line **833** at the extension portion **834**.

[0174] The extension portions **834** extend along the first direction. The extension portions **834** are arranged in the second direction. The second direction is perpendicular to the first direction. The multiple protruding portions **836** each protrude in the second direction. In the example, the first direction is the circumferential direction D_c , and the second direction is the radial direction D_r . That is, the extension portions **834** extend along the circumferential direction D_c and are arranged in the radial direction D_r . The protruding portions **836** protrude in the radial direction D_r .

[0175] The multiple extension portions **834** include a first extension portion **834a**, a second extension portion **834b**, and a third extension portion **834c**. The third extension portion **834c** is positioned between the first extension portion **834a** and the second extension portion **834b** in the second direction. That is, for example, the first extension portion **834a** and the second extension portion **834b** are not adjacent to each other. The third extension portion **834c** is provided as necessary and is omissible. That is, the first extension portion **834a** and the second extension portion **834b** may be adjacent to each other. Even when the third extension portion **834c** is provided, a portion of the first extension portion **834a** and a portion of the second extension portion **834b** may be adjacent to each other.

[0176] The multiple protruding portions **836** include a first protruding portion **836a** and a second protruding portion **836b**. The first protruding portion **836a** is provided in the first extension portion **834a** and protrudes toward the second protruding portion **836b**. The second protruding portion **836b** is provided in the second extension portion **834b** and protrudes toward the first protruding portion **836a**.

[0177] The first zone **810** includes a first facing region **841**. In the first facing region **841**, the first protruding portion **836a** and the second protruding portion **836b** are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other. That is, another portion of the first heater line **833** (e.g., another extension

portion **834**, folded portion **835**, or the like) is not included in at least a portion between the first protruding portion **836a** and the second protruding portion **836b**. Another portion of the first heater line **833** (e.g., another extension portion **834**, folded portion **835**, or the like) may be included in a portion between the first protruding portion **836a** and the second protruding portion **836b**. The first facing region **841** may become a cool spot having relatively low temperatures in the plane of the heater unit **200**.

[0178] The first facing region **841** is, for example, the interior of a region surrounded with a first virtual line VL1, a second virtual line VL2, a third virtual line VL3, and a fourth virtual line VL4. The first virtual line VL1 is a line that extends along the first direction and overlaps one end (the inner end portion) in the second direction of the first protruding portion **836a**. The second virtual line VL2 is a line that extends along the first direction and overlaps the other end (the outer end portion) in the second direction of the second protruding portion **836b**. The third virtual line VL3 is a line that extends along the second direction and overlaps the end portion among one end in the first direction of the first protruding portion **836a** and one end in the first direction of the second protruding portion **836b** that is closer to the other end. The fourth virtual line VL4 is a line that extends along the second direction and overlaps the end portion among the other end in the first direction of the first protruding portion **836a** and the other end in the first direction of the second protruding portion **836b** that is closer to the one end.

[0179] The first facing region **841** includes at least a portion of the first protruding portion **836a** and at least a portion of the second protruding portion **836b**. In the example, the first facing region **841** includes the entire first protruding portion **836a** and the entire second protruding portion **836b**. That is, the one end in the first direction of the first protruding portion **836a** overlaps the one end in the first direction of the second protruding portion **836b** in the second direction. The other end in the first direction of the first protruding portion **836a** overlaps the other end in the first direction of the second protruding portion **836b** in the second direction.

[0180] For example, the entire first protruding portion **836a** may not be included in the first facing region **841**. For example, the entire second protruding portion **836b** may not be included in the first facing region **841**. That is, the one end in the first direction of the first protruding portion **836a** may not overlap the one end in the first direction of the second protruding portion **836b** in the second direction. The other end in the first direction of the first protruding portion **836a** may not overlap the other end in the first direction of the second protruding portion **836b** in the second direction.

[0181] In the example, a portion of the third extension portion **834c** is located at a position where the portion of the third extension portion **834c** overlaps the first and second protruding portions **836a** and **836b** in the second direction. That is, the portion of the third extension portion **834c** is located at a position where the portion of the third extension portion **834c** overlaps the first facing region **841**. On the other hand, another portion of the third extension portion **834c** is located at a position where the other portion of the third extension portion **834c** does not overlap the first and second protruding portions **836a** and **836b** in the second direction. That is, the other portion of the third extension portion **834c** is located at a position where the other portion of the third extension portion **834c** does not overlap the first facing region **841**. The third extension portion **834c** may be located at a position where the entire third extension portion **834c** does not overlap the first and second protruding portions **836a** and **836b**, or may be located at a position where a portion of the third extension portion **834c** overlaps the first and second protruding portions **836a** and **836b**.

[0182] The size in the second direction of the first facing region **841** is increased when the third extension portion **834c** or the like is disposed between the first protruding portion **836a** and the second protruding portion **836b** in the second direction. There is a risk that the temperature control may become complex because the first protruding portion **836a** and the second protruding portion **836b**, i.e., the cool spots, are disposed to be more separated. It is favorable for the first and second protruding portions **836a** and **836b** to be disposed so as to be proximate in the second direction as much as possible and for the third extension portion **834c** to be located at a position where the

entire third extension portion **834c** does not overlap the first and second protruding portions **836a** and **836b**.

[0183] FIG. **9** is a plan view schematically illustrating a portion of a first zone of a heater unit according to a modification of the embodiment.

[0184] In the example as illustrated in FIG. **9**, the first direction is the circumferential direction D_c , and the second direction is the radial direction D_r . That is, the extension portions **834** extend along the circumferential direction D_c and are arranged in the radial direction D_r . The protruding portions **836** protrude in the radial direction D_r .

[0185] The multiple protruding portions **836** further include a third protruding portion **836c** in addition to the first and second protruding portions **836a** and **836b**. The third protruding portion **836c** is provided in the first extension portion **834a** and protrudes toward the second protruding portion **836b**. The third protruding portion **836c** is arranged with the first protruding portion **836a** in the first direction.

[0186] In the example as well, the first zone **810** includes the first facing region **841**. In the first facing region **841**, the first protruding portion **836a** and the second protruding portion **836b** are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other. The first facing region **841** includes a portion of the first protruding portion **836a** and a portion of the second protruding portion **836b**. That is, one end in the first direction of the first protruding portion **836a** does not overlap one end in the first direction of the second protruding portion **836b** in the second direction. The other end in the first direction of the first protruding portion **836a** does not overlap the other end in the first direction of the second protruding portion **836b** in the second direction.

[0187] For example, the entire first protruding portion **836a** may be included in the first facing region **841**. That is, the other end in the first direction of the first protruding portion **836a** may overlap the other end in the first direction of the second protruding portion **836b** in the second direction.

[0188] The first zone **810** further includes a second facing region **842**. In the second facing region **842**, the third protruding portion **836c** and the second protruding portion **836b** are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other. That is, another portion of the first heater line **833** (e.g., another extension portion **834**, folded portion **835**, or the like) is not included in at least a portion between the third protruding portion **836c** and the second protruding portion **836b**. Another portion of the first heater line **833** (e.g., another extension portion **834**, folded portion **835**, or the like) may be included in a portion between the third protruding portion **836c** and the second protruding portion **836b**. The second facing region **842** may become a cool spot having relatively low temperatures in the plane of the heater unit **200**.

[0189] The second facing region **842** is, for example, the interior of a region surrounded with a fifth virtual line VL5, a sixth virtual line VL6, a seventh virtual line VL7, and an eighth virtual line VL8. The fifth virtual line VL5 is a line that extends along the first direction and overlaps one end (the inner end portion) in the second direction of the third protruding portion **836c**. The sixth virtual line VL6 is a line that extends along the first direction and overlaps the other end (the outer end portion) in the second direction of the second protruding portion **836b**. The seventh virtual line VL7 is a line that extends along the second direction and overlaps the end portion among one end in the first direction of the third protruding portion **836c** and one end in the first direction of the second protruding portion **836b** that is closer to the other end. The eighth virtual line VL8 is a line that extends along the second direction and overlaps the end portion among the other end in the first direction of the third protruding portion **836c** and the other end in the first direction of the second protruding portion **836b** that is closer to the one end.

[0190] The second facing region **842** includes at least a portion of the third protruding portion **836c** and at least a portion of the second protruding portion **836b**. In the example, the second facing region **842** includes a portion of the third protruding portion **836c** and a portion of the second protruding portion **836b**. That is, the one end in the first direction of the third protruding portion

836c does not overlap the one end in the first direction of the second protruding portion **836b** in the second direction. The other end in the first direction of the third protruding portion **836c** does not overlap the other end in the first direction of the second protruding portion **836b** in the second direction.

[0191] For example, the entire third protruding portion **836c** may be included in the second facing region **842**. That is, the one end in the first direction of the third protruding portion **836c** may overlap the one end in the first direction of the second protruding portion **836b** in the second direction.

[0192] In the example, two protruding portions also are disposed in the second extension portion **834b** at the two sides of the second protruding portion **836b** in the first direction. That is, in the example, five protruding portions are disposed so as to be proximate to each other. The number of cool spots in the entire plane can be relatively low by disposing many protruding portions so as to be aggregated. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object can be increased while suppressing complex temperature control.

[0193] For example, the third extension portion **834c** is located at a position where the third extension portion **834c** does not overlap the third and second protruding portions **836c** and **836b** in the second direction. For example, the third extension portion **834c** is located at a position where the third extension portion **834c** does not overlap the second facing region **842**.

[0194] FIG. **10** is a plan view schematically illustrating a portion of a first zone of a heater unit according to a modification of the embodiment.

[0195] In the example as illustrated in FIG. **10**, the first direction is the radial direction D_r , and the second direction is the circumferential direction D_c . That is, the extension portions **834** extend along the radial direction D_r and are arranged in the circumferential direction D_c . The protruding portions **836** protrude in the circumferential direction D_c .

[0196] In the example as well, the first zone **810** includes the first facing region **841**. In the first facing region **841**, the first protruding portion **836a** and the second protruding portion **836b** are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other. The first facing region **841** is substantially the same as that of the example shown in FIG. **8**, and a description is therefore omitted.

[0197] FIG. **11** is a plan view schematically illustrating a portion of a first zone of a heater unit according to a modification of the embodiment.

[0198] In the example as illustrated in FIG. **11**, the first direction is the radial direction D_r , and the second direction is the circumferential direction D_c . That is, the extension portions **834** extend along the radial direction D_r and are arranged in the circumferential direction D_c . The protruding portions **836** protrude in the circumferential direction D_c .

[0199] The multiple protruding portions **836** further include a third protruding portion **836c**, a fourth protruding portion **836d**, and a fifth protruding portion **836e** in addition to the first and second protruding portions **836a** and **836b**. The first protruding portion **836a**, the third protruding portion **836c**, and the fifth protruding portion **836e** are arranged in the first direction. The second protruding portion **836b** and the fourth protruding portion **836d** are arranged in the first direction. The third protruding portion **836c** is provided in the first extension portion **834a** and protrudes toward the second and fourth protruding portions **836b** and **836d**. The fifth protruding portion **836e** is provided in the first extension portion **834a** and protrudes toward the fourth protruding portion **836d**. The fourth protruding portion **836d** is provided in the second extension portion **834b** and protrudes toward the third and fifth protruding portions **836c** and **836e**.

[0200] In the example as well, the first zone **810** includes the first facing region **841** and the second facing region **842**. In the first facing region **841**, the first protruding portion **836a** and the second protruding portion **836b** are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other. In the second facing region **842**, the third protruding portion **836c** and the second protruding portion **836b** are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other. The first facing region **841** and the second facing region **842** are substantially the same as those of the example shown in FIG. **9**, and a

description is therefore omitted.

[0201] In the example, the first zone **810** further includes a third facing region **843** and a fourth facing region **844**. In the third facing region **843**, the third protruding portion **836c** and the fourth protruding portion **836d** are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other. In the fourth facing region **844**, the fifth protruding portion **836e** and the fourth protruding portion **836d** are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other. Other than including the protruding portions **836** of different configurations, the third facing region **843** and the fourth facing region **844** are substantially the same as the first and second facing regions **841** and **842**, and a description is therefore omitted. The third facing region **843** and the fourth facing region **844** may become cool spots having relatively low temperatures in the plane of the heater unit **200**.

[0202] FIG. **12** is a plan view schematically illustrating a portion of a first zone of a heater unit according to a modification of the embodiment.

[0203] As illustrated in FIG. **12**, the first zone **810** also may include a fifth facing region **845**. For example, the fifth facing region **845** is located at a corner portion **838** at which the first heater line **833** is bent. In the fifth facing region **845**, portions of the first heater line **833** are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other. More specifically, in the example, the first heater line **833** includes the first protruding portion **836a** and the second protruding portion **836b**. The first protruding portion **836a** and the second protruding portion **836b** each are curved. The curve direction of the first protruding portion **836a** is opposite to the curve direction of the second protruding portion **836b**. The first protruding portion **836a** protrudes toward the second protruding portion **836b**. The second protruding portion **836b** protrudes toward the first protruding portion **836a**. In the fifth facing region **845**, the first protruding portion **836a** and the second protruding portion **836b** are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other. The fifth facing region **845** may become a cool spot having relatively low temperatures in the plane of the heater unit **200**.

[0204] FIGS. **13** and **14** are plan views schematically illustrating the positional relationship between a second zone and a portion of the first zone of the heater unit according to the first embodiment.

[0205] FIGS. **13** and **14** are enlarged illustrations of a second zone **910** and the portion of the first zone **810** of the heater unit **200**. The second zone **910** is one of the multiple zones included in the second heater element of the heater unit **200**. The second heater element is a different heater element from the first heater element. The second heater element may be the sub-heater element **231** or may be the main heater element **232**. That is, the second zone **910** may be one of the sub-zones **700** of the sub-heater element **231** or one of the main zones **600** of the main heater element **232**. The second zone **910** overlaps the first zone **810** in the Z-direction.

[0206] As illustrated in FIG. **13**, the second zone **910** includes a third power feeding portion **931**, a fourth power feeding portion **932**, and a second heater line **933**. The second heater line **933** generates heat by allowing a current to flow. The third power feeding portion **931** and the fourth power feeding portion **932** feed power to the second heater line **933**. The third power feeding portion **931**, the fourth power feeding portion **932**, and the second heater line **933** are not illustrated in FIG. **14**.

[0207] When the second zone **910** is one of the sub-zones **700**, the third power feeding portion **931**, the fourth power feeding portion **932**, and the second heater line **933** are respectively the first sub-power feeding portion **231a**, the second sub-power feeding portion **231b**, and the sub-heater line **231c**. When the second zone **910** is one of the main zones **600**, the third power feeding portion **931**, the fourth power feeding portion **932**, and the second heater line **933** are respectively the first main power feeding portion **232a**, the second main power feeding portion **232b**, and the main heater line **232c**.

[0208] Although an example will now be described in which the first zone **810** is one of the main zones **600** of the main heater element **232** and the second zone **910** is one of the sub-zones **700** of the sub-heater element **231**, the first zone **810** may be one of the sub-zones **700** of the sub-heater

element **231**, and the second zone **910** may be one of the main zones **600** of the main heater element **232**.

[0209] As illustrated in FIG. **14**, the second zone **910** includes a central region **911** and an outer peripheral region **912**. The central region **911** is positioned at the center of the second zone **910** when viewed in plan. The outer peripheral region **912** is positioned outside the central region **911** when viewed in plan. For example, the temperature of the central region **911** exceeds the temperature of the outer peripheral region **912** when the second zone **910** is heated.

[0210] In the example, the second zone **910** is a region surrounded with an inner circumference end **921**, an outer circumference end **922**, a side end **923**, and a side end **924**. The inner circumference end **921** overlaps one end in the second direction (the inner end portion in the radial direction Dr) of one of the third power feeding portion **931**, the fourth power feeding portion **932**, or the second heater line **933** included in the second zone **910**. The outer circumference end **922** overlaps the other end in the second direction (the outer end portion in the radial direction Dr) of one of the third power feeding portion **931**, the fourth power feeding portion **932**, or the second heater line **933** included in the second zone **910**. In the example, the inner circumference end **921** and the outer circumference end **922** have circular arc shapes.

[0211] The side end **923** is positioned between one end of the inner circumference end **921** and one end of the outer circumference end **922**. The side end **923** overlaps one end in the first direction (the end portion at one side in the circumferential direction Dc) of one of the third power feeding portion **931**, the fourth power feeding portion **932**, or the second heater line **933** included in the second zone **910**. The side end **924** is positioned between the other end of the inner circumference end **921** and the other end of the outer circumference end **922**. The side end **924** overlaps the other end in the first direction (the end portion at the other side in the circumferential direction Dc) of one of the third power feeding portion **931**, the fourth power feeding portion **932**, or the second heater line **933** included in the second zone **910**. In the example, the side end **923** and the side end **924** have linear shapes.

[0212] The central region **911** includes, for example, a center **915** of the second zone **910**. The center **915** is the intersection between a center line $RL21$ of the second direction (the radial direction Dr) between the inner circumference end **921** and the outer circumference end **922** and a center line $CL21$ of the first direction (the circumferential direction Dc) between the side end **923** and the side end **924**.

[0213] The central region **911** is the region between a center line $RL22$ of the second direction (the radial direction Dr) between the inner circumference end **921** and the center line $RL21$ and a center line $RL23$ of the second direction (the radial direction Dr) between the outer circumference end **922** and the center line $RL21$, and between a center line $CL22$ of the first direction (the circumferential direction Dc) between the side end **923** and the center line $CL21$ and a center line $CL23$ of the first direction (the circumferential direction Dc) between the side end **924** and the center line $CL21$. That is, the central region **911** is the interior of the region surrounded with the center line $RL22$, the center line $RL23$, the center line $CL22$, and the center line $CL23$.

[0214] The outer peripheral region **912** is the region positioned outward of the center line $RL22$, the center line $RL23$, the center line $CL22$, and the center line $CL23$ (that is, at the side opposite to the center **915**). In other words, the outer peripheral region **912** is positioned between the center line $RL22$ and the inner circumference end **921**, between the center line $RL23$ and the outer circumference end **922**, between the center line $CL22$ and the side end **923**, and between the center line $CL23$ and the side end **924**.

[0215] In the example, the first facing region **841** of the first zone **810** is located at a position where the first facing region **841** overlaps the central region **911** of the second zone **910** in the Z-direction.

[0216] In this specification, the first facing region **841** being “located at a position where the first facing region **841** overlaps the central region **911**” means that at least a portion of the first facing region **841** overlaps the central region **911** in the Z-direction. That is, the first facing region **841** is

considered to be located in the central region **911** even when the first facing region **841** is located on the boundary between the central region **911** and the outer peripheral region **912**. In other words, the first facing region **841** is considered to be located in the outer peripheral region **912** when no portion of the first facing region **841** overlaps the central region **911** in the Z-direction. This is similar for the second facing region **842**, the third facing region **843**, the fourth facing region **844**, and the fifth facing region **845** as well.

[0217] When the number of zones of the heater unit **200** is increased to increase the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object W, the number of power feeding portions, power feeding terminals, and the like for feeding power to the zones is increased. When the number of the power feeding portions and the like is increased, the number of the protruding portions **836** provided in the heater line to avoid the power feeding portions and the like also is increased. Normally, current flows over the shortest distance, so when a current flows in the protruding portion **836** of the heater line, the current flows more easily at the inner side of the protruding portion **836** than at the outer side of the protruding portion **836**. Accordingly, the generated heat amount is likely to be less at the outer side of the protruding portion **836** than at the inner side of the protruding portion **836**. That is, the protruding portions **836** are likely to become cool spots.

[0218] To increase the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the heater unit **200**, for example, it may be considered to dispose the protruding portions **836** so as to be dispersed in the plane of the heater unit **200**. However, when the protruding portions **836** are disposed so as to be dispersed in the plane of the heater unit **200**, there is a risk that the temperature control may become complex due to the dispersion of the cool spots. On the other hand, when the protruding portions **836** are disposed so as to be aggregated in the plane of the heater unit **200**, there is a risk that the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the heater unit **200** may degrade due to the reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots.

[0219] In contrast, according to the embodiment, the first facing region **841** of the first zone **810** in which the first protruding portion **836a** and the second protruding portion **836b** are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other (i.e., the protruding portions **836** are aggregated) is located in a position where the first facing region **841** overlaps the central region **911**, which is likely to have a higher temperature than the outer peripheral region **912** in the second zone **910**. Accordingly, a drastic reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots can be suppressed by suppressing the dispersion of the cool spots and by the first facing region **841** of the first zone **810**, i.e., the cool spot, overlapping the central region **911** of the second zone **910**, i.e., the hotspot. That is, the temperature unevenness can be canceled. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object W can be increased while suppressing complex temperature control.

[0220] It is favorable for at least one of the second facing region **842**, the third facing region **843**, the fourth facing region **844**, or the fifth facing region **845** to be located at a position where the at least one of the second facing region **842**, the third facing region **843**, the fourth facing region **844**, or the fifth facing region **845** overlaps the central region **911** of the second zone **910** in the Z-direction. Similarly to the first facing region **841**, these regions also are likely to become cool spots; therefore, a drastic reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots can be suppressed by these regions overlapping the central region **911** of the second zone **910**, i.e., the hotspot.

[0221] FIG. **15** is a plan view schematically illustrating a first zone of a heater unit according to a second embodiment.

[0222] As illustrated in FIG. **15**, the first zone **810** includes a central region **811** and an outer peripheral region **812**. The central region **811** is positioned at the center of the first zone **810** when viewed in plan. The outer peripheral region **812** is positioned outside the central region **811** when viewed in plan. For example, the temperature of the central region **811** exceeds the temperature of the outer peripheral region **812** when the first zone **810** is heated.

[0223] In the example, the first zone **810** is a region surrounded with an inner circumference end **821**, an outer circumference end **822**, a side end **823**, and a side end **824**. The inner circumference end **821** overlaps one end in the second direction (the inner end portion in the radial direction Dr) of one of the first power feeding portion **831**, the second power feeding portion **832**, or the first heater line **833** included in the first zone **810**. The outer circumference end **822** overlaps the other end in the second direction (the outer end portion in the radial direction Dr) of one of the first power feeding portion **831**, the second power feeding portion **832**, or the first heater line **833** included in the first zone **810**. In the example, the inner circumference end **821** and the outer circumference end **822** have circular arc shapes.

[0224] The side end **823** is positioned between one end of the inner circumference end **821** and one end of the outer circumference end **822**. The side end **823** overlaps one end in the first direction (the end portion at one side in the circumferential direction Dc) of one of the first power feeding portion **831**, the second power feeding portion **832**, or the first heater line **833** included in the first zone **810**. The side end **824** is positioned between the other end of the inner circumference end **821** and the other end of the outer circumference end **822**. The side end **824** overlaps the other end in the first direction (the end portion at the other side in the circumferential direction Dc) of one of the first power feeding portion **831**, the second power feeding portion **832**, or the first heater line **833** included in the first zone **810**. In the example, the side end **823** and the side end **824** have linear shapes.

[0225] The central region **811** includes, for example, a center **815** of the first zone **810**. The center **815** is the intersection between a center line RL**11** of the radial direction Dr between the inner circumference end **821** and the outer circumference end **822** and a center line CL**11** of the circumferential direction Dc between the side end **823** and the side end **824**.

[0226] The central region **811** is a region between a center line RL**12** of the second direction (the radial direction Dr) between the inner circumference end **821** and the center line RL**11** and a center line RL**13** of the second direction (the radial direction Dr) between the outer circumference end **822** and the center line RL**11**, and between a center line CL**12** of the first direction (the circumferential direction Dc) between the side end **823** and the center line CL**11** and a center line CL**13** of the first direction (the circumferential direction Dc) between the side end **824** and the center line CL**11**. That is, the central region **811** is the interior of the region surrounded with the center line RL**12**, the center line RL**13**, the center line CL**12**, and the center line CL**13**.

[0227] The outer peripheral region **812** is the region positioned outward of the center line RL**12**, the center line RL**13**, the center line CL**12**, and the center line CL**13** (that is, at the side opposite to the center **815**). In other words, the outer peripheral region **812** is positioned between the center line RL**12** and the inner circumference end **821**, between the center line RL**13** and the outer circumference end **822**, between the center line CL**12** and the side end **823**, and between the center line CL**13** and the side end **824**.

[0228] In the example, the first facing region **841** of the first zone **810** is located in the central region **811** of the first zone **810**.

[0229] In this specification, the first facing region **841** being “located in the central region **811**” means that at least a portion of the first facing region **841** overlaps the central region **811** in the Z-direction. That is, the first facing region **841** is considered to be located in the central region **811** even when the first facing region **841** is located on the boundary between the central region **811** and the outer peripheral region **812**. In other words, the first facing region **841** is considered to be located in the outer peripheral region **812** when no portion of the first facing region **841** overlaps the central region **811** in the Z-direction. This is similar for the second facing region **842**, the third facing region **843**, the fourth facing region **844**, and the fifth facing region **845** as well.

[0230] According to the embodiment, the first facing region **841** of the first zone **810** in which the first protruding portion **836a** and the second protruding portion **836b** are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other (i.e., the protruding portions **836** are aggregated) is located in the central

region **811**, which is likely to have a higher temperature than the outer peripheral region **812** in the first zone **810**. Accordingly, a drastic reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots can be suppressed by suppressing the dispersion of the cool spots and by providing the first facing region **841** of the first zone **810**, i.e., the cool spot, in the central region **811** of the first zone **810**, i.e., the hotspot. That is, the temperature unevenness can be canceled. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object W can be increased while suppressing complex temperature control.

[0231] It is favorable for at least one of the second facing region **842**, the third facing region **843**, the fourth facing region **844**, or the fifth facing region **845** to be located in the central region **811** of the first zone **810**. Similarly to the first facing region **841**, these regions also are likely to become cool spots; therefore, a drastic reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots can be suppressed by providing these regions in the central region **811** of the first zone **810**, i.e., the hotspot.

[0232] In the example, the heater unit **200** also includes the first heater element including the first zone **810**, the bypass layer **250** (see FIGS. 3 and 4) that is a power feeding path to the first heater element, and a first power feeding terminal **281** and a second power feeding terminal **282** electrically connected to the bypass layer **250**. The first power feeding terminal **281** and the second power feeding terminal **282** are, for example, a pair of power feeding terminals **280** among the power feeding terminals **280** connected to the same bypass layer **250**. Each of the first and second power feeding terminals **281** and **282** is, for example, one of the power feeding terminals **280a** to **280j** described above.

[0233] The first power feeding portion **831** is located at a position where the first power feeding portion **831** does not overlap the first power feeding terminal **281** in the Z-direction. The first power feeding portion **831** is electrically connected to the first power feeding terminal **281** via the bypass layer **250**. The second power feeding portion **832** is located at a position where the second power feeding portion **832** does not overlap the second power feeding terminal **282** in the Z-direction. The second power feeding portion **832** is electrically connected to the second power feeding terminal **282** via the bypass layer **250**.

[0234] The first facing region **841** is located at a position where the first facing region **841** overlaps at least one of the first power feeding terminal **281** or the second power feeding terminal **282** in the Z-direction. For example, the first facing region **841** is located at a position where the first facing region **841** overlaps the first and second power feeding terminals **281** and **282** in the Z-direction. For example, the first facing region **841** may be located at a position where the first facing region **841** overlaps the first power feeding terminal **281** but does not overlap the second power feeding terminal **282** in the Z-direction. For example, the first facing region **841** may be located at a position where the first facing region **841** overlaps the second power feeding terminal **282** but does not overlap the first power feeding terminal **281** in the Z-direction.

[0235] In this specification, the first facing region **841** being “located at a position where the first facing region **841** overlaps the first power feeding terminal **281**” means that at least a portion of the first facing region **841** overlaps the first power feeding terminal **281** in the Z-direction. That is, the first facing region **841** is considered to be located at a position where the first facing region **841** overlaps the first power feeding terminal **281** even when the first facing region **841** is located on the boundary between the first power feeding terminal **281** and other portions. In other words, the first facing region **841** is considered to be located at a position where the first facing region **841** does not overlap the first power feeding terminal **281** when no portion of the first facing region **841** overlaps the first power feeding terminal **281** in the Z-direction. This is similar for the second power feeding terminal **282** as well. This is similar for the second facing region **842**, the third facing region **843**, the fourth facing region **844**, and the fifth facing region **845** as well.

[0236] Even when the coolant flow path **301** for allowing a cooling medium to flow is provided inside the base plate **300**, the coolant flow path **301** is not provided at a position at which the power feeding terminal **280** for feeding power to the bypass layer **250** is located. Therefore, the position at

which the power feeding terminal **280** is located is difficult to cool compared to the other positions, and is likely to become a hotspot.

[0237] According to the embodiment, the first facing region **841** of the first zone **810** in which the first protruding portion **836a** and the second protruding portion **836b** are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other (i.e., the protruding portions **836** are aggregated) is located in a position where the first facing region **841** overlaps at least one of the first power feeding terminal **281** or the second power feeding terminal **282**. Accordingly, a drastic reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots can be suppressed by suppressing the dispersion of the cool spots and by the first facing region **841** of the first zone **810**, i.e., the cool spot, overlapping the first and second power feeding terminals **281** and **282**, i.e., the hotspots. That is, the temperature unevenness can be canceled. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object W can be increased while suppressing complex temperature control.

[0238] It is favorable for at least one of the second facing region **842**, the third facing region **843**, the fourth facing region **844**, or the fifth facing region **845** to be located at a position where the at least one of the second facing region **842**, the third facing region **843**, the fourth facing region **844**, or the fifth facing region **845** overlaps at least one of the first power feeding terminal **281** or the second power feeding terminal **282** in the Z-direction. Similarly to the first facing region **841**, these regions also are likely to become cool spots; therefore, a drastic reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots can be suppressed by these regions overlapping the first and second power feeding terminals **281** and **282**, i.e., the hotspots.

[0239] FIG. **16** is a plan view schematically illustrating a first zone of a heater unit according to a third embodiment.

[0240] In the example as illustrated in FIG. **16**, the first zone **810** includes an outer circumference edge **810e** of the first heater element. That is, in the example, the first zone **810** is positioned at the outermost circumference portion of the first heater element. When the first zone **810** is one of the sub-zones **700**, the outer circumference edge **810e** is the outer circumference edge **231e** of the sub-heater element **231**. When the first zone **810** is one of the main zones **600**, the outer circumference edge **810e** is the outer circumference edge **232e** of the main heater element **232**.

[0241] The first zone **810** includes an inner circumference portion **851** and an outer circumference portion **852**. The inner circumference portion **851** is a portion positioned at one side in the second direction (the inner side in the radial direction Dr) of the center line RL**11** of the second direction (the radial direction Dr). The outer circumference portion **852** is a portion positioned at the other side in the second direction (the outer side in the radial direction Dr) of the center line RL**11** of the second direction (the radial direction Dr). The outer circumference portion **852** includes the outer circumference edge **810e** of the first heater element. The center line RL**11** of the second direction (the radial direction Dr) passes through the center in the second direction (the radial direction Dr) between the inner circumference end **821** and the outer circumference end **822** of the first zone **810**. That is, the center line RL**11** of the second direction (the radial direction Dr) bisects the first zone **810** in the second direction (the radial direction Dr). For example, the temperature of the inner circumference portion **851** exceeds the temperature of the outer circumference portion **852** when the first zone **810** is heated.

[0242] In the example, the first facing region **841** of the first zone **810** is located in the inner circumference portion **851** of the first zone **810**.

[0243] In this specification, the first facing region **841** being “located in the inner circumference portion **851**” means that at least a portion of the first facing region **841** overlaps the inner circumference portion **851** in the Z-direction. That is, the first facing region **841** is considered to be located in the inner circumference portion **851** even when the first facing region **841** is located on the boundary between the inner circumference portion **851** and the outer circumference portion **852**. In other words, the first facing region **841** is considered to be located in the outer circumference portion **852** when no portion of the first facing region **841** overlaps the inner

circumference portion **851** in the Z-direction. This is similar for the second facing region **842**, the third facing region **843**, the fourth facing region **844**, and the fifth facing region **845** as well.

[0244] According to the embodiment, the first facing region **841** of the first zone **810** in which the first protruding portion **836a** and the second protruding portion **836b** are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other (i.e., the protruding portions **836** are aggregated) is located in the inner circumference portion **851**, which is likely to have a higher temperature than the outer circumference portion **852** in the first zone **810**. Accordingly, a drastic reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots can be suppressed by suppressing the dispersion of the cool spots and by providing the first facing region **841** of the first zone **810**, i.e., the cool spot, in the inner circumference portion **851** of the first zone **810**, i.e., the hotspot. That is, the temperature unevenness can be canceled. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object W can be increased while suppressing complex temperature control.

[0245] It is favorable for at least one of the second facing region **842**, the third facing region **843**, the fourth facing region **844**, or the fifth facing region **845** to be located in the inner circumference portion **851** of the first zone **810**. Similarly to the first facing region **841**, these regions also are likely to become cool spots; therefore, a drastic reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots can be suppressed by providing these regions in the inner circumference portion **851** of the first zone **810**, i.e., the hotspot.

[0246] It is favorable for the multiple zones of the first heater element including the first zone **810** to be divided in the radial direction D_r , and for the first direction to be the circumferential direction D_c . The control of the in-plane temperature of the process object W can be efficiently performed thereby.

[0247] It is also favorable for the multiple zones of the first heater element including the first zone **810** to be divided in the radial direction D_r , and for the first direction to be the radial direction D_r . The control of the in-plane temperature of the process object W can be efficiently performed thereby.

[0248] As described above, the first protruding portion **836a** and the second protruding portion **836b** are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other. Therefore, there are cases where the shortest distance between the first extension portion **834a** and the second extension portion **834b** is greater than the shortest distance when the first protruding portion **836a** and the second protruding portion **836b** are not formed. It is therefore favorable for the multiple extension portions **834** of the first zone **810** to include the third extension portion **834c** positioned between the first extension portion **834a** and the second extension portion **834b** in the second direction. Accordingly, the third extension portion **834c** can prevent the gap between the first extension portion **834a** and the second extension portion **834b** from becoming too wide. In such a case, it is favorable for the third extension portion **834c** to be located at a position where the third extension portion **834c** does not overlap the first and second protruding portions **836a** and **836b** in the second direction. Accordingly, the area of the first facing region **841** can be relatively small. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object W can be increased.

[0249] There are cases where the multiple protruding portions **836** of the first zone **810** include the third protruding portion **836c** that is provided in the first extension portion **834a** and protrudes toward the second protruding portion **836b**. In such a case, it is favorable for the third protruding portion **836c** to be disposed so as to face and be adjacent to the second protruding portion **836b**. Thus, the number of cool spots in the entire plane can be relatively low by disposing a region (the second facing region **842**) in which the second protruding portion **836b** and the third protruding portion **836c** are aggregated proximate to the first facing region **841**. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object W can be increased while suppressing complex temperature control.

[0250] FIG. **17** is a plan view schematically illustrating a first zone of a heater unit according to a fourth embodiment.

[0251] In the example, the heater unit **200** includes the first heater element including the first zone **810**, the second heater element including the second zone **910**, the bypass layer **250** (see FIGS. **3** and **4**) that is a power feeding path to the first and second heater elements, and the first power feeding terminal **281**, the second power feeding terminal **282**, a third power feeding terminal **283**, and a fourth power feeding terminal **284** electrically connected to the bypass layer **250**. The first power feeding terminal **281** and the second power feeding terminal **282** are, for example, a pair of power feeding terminals **280** among the power feeding terminals **280** connected to the same bypass layer **250**. The third power feeding terminal **283** and the fourth power feeding terminal **284** are, for example, a pair of power feeding terminals **280** among the power feeding terminals **280** connected to the same bypass layer **250**. Each of the first power feeding terminal **281**, the second power feeding terminal **282**, the third power feeding terminal **283**, and the fourth power feeding terminal **284** is, for example, one of the power feeding terminals **280a** to **280j** described above.

[0252] The first power feeding portion **831** of the first zone **810** is located at a position where the first power feeding portion **831** does not overlap the first power feeding terminal **281** in the Z-direction. The first power feeding portion **831** is electrically connected to the first power feeding terminal **281** via the bypass layer **250**. The second power feeding portion **832** of the first zone **810** is located at a position where the second power feeding portion **832** does not overlap the second power feeding terminal **282** in the Z-direction. The second power feeding portion **832** is electrically connected to the second power feeding terminal **282** via the bypass layer **250**.

[0253] The third power feeding portion **931** of the second zone **910** is located at a position where the third power feeding portion **931** does not overlap the third power feeding terminal **283** in the Z-direction. The third power feeding portion **931** is electrically connected to the third power feeding terminal **283** via the bypass layer **250**. The fourth power feeding portion **932** of the second zone **910** is located at a position where the fourth power feeding portion **932** does not overlap the fourth power feeding terminal **284** in the Z-direction. The fourth power feeding portion **932** is electrically connected to the fourth power feeding terminal **284** via the bypass layer **250**.

[0254] In the example, at least one of the third power feeding terminal **283** or the fourth power feeding terminal **284** is located at a position where the at least one of the third power feeding terminal **283** or the fourth power feeding terminal **284** overlaps a virtual line segment VLS in the Z-direction; and the virtual line segment VLS connects a center CT3 of the first power feeding portion **831** and a center CT4 of the second power feeding portion **832**. As shown, such VLS is a straight line which connects the centers CT3 and CT4 at a shortest distance because it is a straight line.

[0255] In this specification, the third power feeding terminal **283** being “located at a position where the third power feeding terminal **283** overlaps the virtual line segment VLS” means that at least a portion of the third power feeding terminal **283** overlaps the virtual line segment VLS in the Z-direction. That is, the third power feeding terminal **283** is considered to be located at a position where the third power feeding terminal **283** overlaps the virtual line segment VLS not only when the third power feeding terminal **283** is at a position P1, but also when the third power feeding terminal **283** is at a position P2 and when the third power feeding terminal **283** is at a position P3. A center CT5 of the third power feeding terminal **283** overlaps the virtual line segment VLS when the third power feeding terminal **283** is at the position P1. The center CT5 of the third power feeding terminal **283** does not overlap the virtual line segment VLS when the third power feeding terminal **283** is at the position P2 or the position P3. This is similar for the fourth power feeding terminal **284** as well. A center CT6 of the fourth power feeding terminal **284** overlaps the virtual line segment VLS when the fourth power feeding terminal **284** is at the position P1. The center CT6 of the fourth power feeding terminal **284** does not overlap the virtual line segment VLS when the fourth power feeding terminal **284** is at the position P2 or the position P3.

[0256] According to the embodiment, at least one of the third power feeding terminal **283** or the fourth power feeding terminal **284** for feeding power to the second heater element via the bypass

layer **250** is located at a position where the at least one of the third power feeding terminal **283** or the fourth power feeding terminal **284** overlaps the virtual line segment VLS connecting the center CT3 of the first power feeding portion **831** and the center CT4 of the second power feeding portion **832** that feed power to the first heater line **833**. Accordingly, the temperature unevenness can be canceled by providing the third power feeding terminal **283** and the fourth power feeding terminal **284**, i.e., the hotspots, between the first power feeding portion **831** and the second power feeding portion **832**, i.e., the cool spots. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object W can be increased while suppressing complex temperature control.

[0257] It is favorable for at least one of the center CT5 of the third power feeding terminal **283** or the center CT6 of the fourth power feeding terminal **284** to be located at a position where the at least one of the center CT5 of the third power feeding terminal **283** or the center CT6 of the fourth power feeding terminal **284** overlaps the virtual line segment VLS. That is, it is favorable for at least one of the center CT5 of the third power feeding terminal **283** or the fourth power feeding terminal **284** to be at the position P1. The uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object W can be increased thereby.

[0258] In the example, the first zone **810** includes the outer circumference edge **810e** of the first heater element. That is, in the example, the first zone **810** is positioned at the outermost circumference portion of the first heater element. In the example, the first zone **810** includes the inner circumference portion **851** and the outer circumference portion **852**. The inner circumference portion **851** and the outer circumference portion **852** are substantially the same as the inner circumference portion **851** and the outer circumference portion **852** of FIG. 16 above, and a description is therefore omitted.

[0259] In the example, both the first and second power feeding portions **831** and **832** are located in the inner circumference portion **851** of the first zone **810**. When the first zone **810** is positioned at the outermost circumference portion of the first heater element, it is favorable for at least one of the first power feeding portion **831** or the second power feeding portion **832** to be located in the inner circumference portion **851** of the first zone **810**.

[0260] In this specification, the first power feeding portion **831** being “located in the inner circumference portion **851**” means that at least a portion of the first power feeding portion **831** overlaps the inner circumference portion **851** in the Z-direction. That is, the first power feeding portion **831** is considered to be located in the inner circumference portion **851** even when the first power feeding portion **831** is located on the boundary between the inner circumference portion **851** and the outer circumference portion **852**. In other words, the first power feeding portion **831** is considered to be located in the outer circumference portion **852** when no portion of the first power feeding portion **831** overlaps the inner circumference portion **851** in the Z-direction. This is similar for the second power feeding portion **832**, the third power feeding portion **931**, and the fourth power feeding portion **932** as well.

[0261] According to the embodiment, when the first zone **810** includes the outer circumference edge **810e** of the first heater element (i.e., the first zone **810** is positioned at the outermost circumference portion of the first heater element), at least one of the first power feeding portion **831** or the second power feeding portion **832** is located in the inner circumference portion **851**, which is likely to have a higher temperature than the outer circumference portion **852** in the first zone **810**. Accordingly, a drastic reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots can be suppressed by providing the first power feeding portion **831** and the second power feeding portion **832**, i.e., the cool spots, in the inner circumference portion **851** of the first zone **810**, i.e., the hotspot. That is, the temperature unevenness can be canceled. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object W can be increased.

[0262] FIG. 18 is a plan view schematically illustrating a first zone of a heater unit according to a fifth embodiment.

[0263] In the example as illustrated in FIG. 18, the first power feeding portion **831** and the second power feeding portion **832** are located in the central region **811** of the first zone **810**. Otherwise, the first zone of the heater unit according to the fifth embodiment is substantially the same as the first zone of the heater unit according to the fourth embodiment illustrated in FIG. 17.

[0264] More specifically, the first zone **810** includes the central region **811** and the outer peripheral region **812**. In the example, the central region **811** is the region between the center line RL12 and the center line RL13. That is, the central region **811** is the interior of the region surrounded with the center lines RL12 and RL13. The outer peripheral region **812** is positioned between the center line RL12 and the inner circumference end **821** and between the center line RL13 and the outer circumference end **822**. Otherwise, the central region **811** and the outer peripheral region **812** are substantially the same as the central region **811** and the outer peripheral region **812** of FIG. 15 above.

[0265] In the example, both the first and second power feeding portions **831** and **832** are located in the central region **811** of the first zone **810**. It is favorable for at least one of the first power feeding portion **831** or the second power feeding portion **832** to be located in the central region **811** of the first zone **810**.

[0266] In this specification, the first power feeding portion **831** being “located in the central region **811**” means that at least a portion of the first power feeding portion **831** overlaps the central region **811** in the Z-direction. That is, the first power feeding portion **831** is considered to be located in the central region **811** even when the first power feeding portion **831** is located on the boundary between the central region **811** and the outer peripheral region **812**. In other words, the first power feeding portion **831** is considered to be located in the outer peripheral region **812** when no portion of the first power feeding portion **831** overlaps the central region **811** in the Z-direction. This is similar for the second power feeding portion **832**, the third power feeding portion **931**, and the fourth power feeding portion **932** as well.

[0267] According to the embodiment, at least one of the first power feeding portion **831** or the second power feeding portion **832** is located in the central region **811**, which is likely to have a higher temperature than the outer peripheral region **812** in the first zone **810**. Accordingly, a drastic reduction of the temperatures at the cool spots can be suppressed by the first and second power feeding portions **831** and **832**, i.e., the cool spots, overlapping the central region **811** of the first zone **810**, i.e., the hotspot. That is, the temperature unevenness can be canceled. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object W can be increased.

[0268] In the example as well, at least one of the third power feeding terminal **283** or the fourth power feeding terminal **284** for feeding power to the second heater element via the bypass layer **250** is located at a position where the at least one of the third power feeding terminal **283** or the fourth power feeding terminal **284** overlaps the virtual line segment VLS connecting the center CT3 of the first power feeding portion **831** and the center CT4 of the second power feeding portion **832** that feed power to the first heater line **833**. Accordingly, the temperature unevenness can be canceled by providing the third power feeding terminal **283** and the fourth power feeding terminal **284**, i.e., the hotspots, between the first power feeding portion **831** and the second power feeding portion **832**, i.e., the cool spots. Accordingly, the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object W can be increased while suppressing complex temperature control.

[0269] Embodiments may include the following configurations.

(Configuration 1)

[0270] An electrostatic chuck, comprising: [0271] a ceramic dielectric substrate having a first major surface configured to have a process object placed thereon and a second major surface opposite to the first major surface; [0272] a base plate having an upper surface and a lower surface, the upper surface being at the ceramic dielectric substrate side, the lower surface being opposite to the upper surface, the base plate supporting the ceramic dielectric substrate; and [0273] a heater

unit which heats the ceramic dielectric substrate, [0274] the heater unit including a first heater element and a second heater element, [0275] the first heater element being located between the first major surface and the upper surface, [0276] the second heater element being located between the first major surface and the first heater element or between the first heater element and the upper surface, [0277] the first heater element including a plurality of zones, [0278] the plurality of zones of the first heater element including a first zone, [0279] the first zone including [0280] a first heater line emitting heat by allowing a current to flow, and [0281] a first power feeding portion and a second power feeding portion feeding power to the first heater line, [0282] the first heater line including [0283] a plurality of extension portions extending along a first direction, the plurality of extension portions being arranged in a second direction perpendicular to the first direction, and [0284] a plurality of protruding portions provided in the plurality of extension portions, the plurality of protruding portions protruding in the second direction, [0285] the plurality of extension portions including a first extension portion and a second extension portion, [0286] the plurality of protruding portions including [0287] a first protruding portion provided in the first extension portion, and [0288] a second protruding portion provided in the second extension portion, [0289] the first protruding portion protruding toward the second protruding portion, [0290] the second protruding portion protruding toward the first protruding portion, [0291] the first zone including a first facing region in which the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other, [0292] the second heater element including a plurality of zones, [0293] the plurality of zones of the second heater element including a second zone, [0294] the second zone including [0295] a second heater line emitting heat by allowing a current to flow, and [0296] a third power feeding portion and a fourth power feeding portion feeding power to the second heater line, [0297] the second zone including [0298] a central region positioned at a center of the second zone when viewed along a Z-direction perpendicular to the first major surface, and [0299] an outer peripheral region positioned outside the central region, [0300] the first facing region being located at a position where the first facing region overlaps the central region in the Z-direction.

(Configuration 2)

[0301] An electrostatic chuck, comprising: [0302] a ceramic dielectric substrate having a first major surface configured to have a process object placed thereon and a second major surface opposite to the first major surface; [0303] a base plate having an upper surface and a lower surface, the upper surface being at the ceramic dielectric substrate side, the lower surface being opposite to the upper surface, the base plate supporting the ceramic dielectric substrate; and [0304] a heater unit which heats the ceramic dielectric substrate, [0305] the heater unit including a first heater element, [0306] the first heater element being located between the first major surface and the upper surface, [0307] the first heater element including a plurality of zones, [0308] the plurality of zones of the first heater element including a first zone, [0309] the first zone including [0310] a first heater line emitting heat by allowing a current to flow, and [0311] a first power feeding portion and a second power feeding portion feeding power to the first heater line, [0312] the first heater line including [0313] a plurality of extension portions extending along a first direction, the plurality of extension portions being arranged in a second direction perpendicular to the first direction, and [0314] a plurality of protruding portions provided in the plurality of extension portions, the plurality of protruding portions protruding in the second direction, [0315] the plurality of extension portions including a first extension portion and a second extension portion, [0316] the plurality of protruding portions including [0317] a first protruding portion provided in the first extension portion, and [0318] a second protruding portion provided in the second extension portion, [0319] the first protruding portion protruding toward the second protruding portion, [0320] the second protruding portion protruding toward the first protruding portion, [0321] the first zone including a first facing region in which the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other, [0322] the first zone including [0323] a central

region positioned at a center of the first zone when viewed along a Z-direction perpendicular to the first major surface, and [0324] an outer peripheral region positioned outside the central region when viewed along the Z-direction, [0325] the first facing region being located in the central region.

(Configuration 3)

[0326] An electrostatic chuck, comprising: [0327] a ceramic dielectric substrate having a first major surface configured to have a process object placed thereon and a second major surface opposite to the first major surface; [0328] a base plate having an upper surface and a lower surface, the upper surface being at the ceramic dielectric substrate side, the lower surface being opposite to the upper surface, the base plate supporting the ceramic dielectric substrate; and [0329] a heater unit which heats the ceramic dielectric substrate, [0330] the heater unit including a first heater element, [0331] the first heater element being located between the first major surface and the upper surface, [0332] the first heater element including a plurality of zones, the plurality of zones being divided in a radial direction, [0333] the plurality of zones of the first heater element including a first zone, [0334] the first zone including [0335] a first heater line emitting heat by allowing a current to flow, and [0336] a first power feeding portion and a second power feeding portion feeding power to the first heater line, [0337] the first heater line including [0338] a plurality of extension portions extending along a first direction, the plurality of extension portions being arranged in a second direction perpendicular to the first direction, and [0339] a plurality of protruding portions provided in the plurality of extension portions, the plurality of protruding portions protruding in the second direction, [0340] the plurality of extension portions including a first extension portion and a second extension portion, [0341] the plurality of protruding portions including [0342] a first protruding portion provided in the first extension portion, and [0343] a second protruding portion provided in the second extension portion, [0344] the first protruding portion protruding toward the second protruding portion, [0345] the second protruding portion protruding toward the first protruding portion, [0346] the first zone including a first facing region in which the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other, [0347] the first zone includes an outer circumference edge of the first heater element, [0348] the first zone includes: [0349] an inner circumference portion positioned radially inward of a center line of a radial direction, the center line of the radial direction bisecting the first zone in the radial direction; and [0350] an outer circumference portion positioned radially outward of the center line of the radial direction, the outer circumference portion including the outer circumference edge, and [0351] the first facing region being located in the inner circumference portion.

(Configuration 4)

[0352] The chuck according to any one of configurations 1 to 3, wherein [0353] the plurality of zones of the first heater element is divided in a radial direction, and [0354] the first direction is a circumferential direction.

(Configuration 5)

[0355] The chuck according to any one of configurations 1 to 3, wherein [0356] the plurality of zones of the first heater element is divided in a radial direction, and [0357] the first direction is the radial direction.

(Configuration 6)

[0358] The chuck according to any one of configurations 1 to 5, wherein [0359] the plurality of extension portions further includes a third extension portion positioned between the first extension portion and the second extension portion in the second direction, and [0360] the third extension portion is located at a position where the third extension portion does not overlap the first and second protruding portions in the second direction.

(Configuration 7)

[0361] The chuck according to any one of configurations 1 to 6, wherein [0362] the plurality of

protruding portions further includes a third protruding portion provided in the first extension portion, [0363] the third protruding portion protrudes toward the second protruding portion, and [0364] the third protruding portion is disposed so as to face the second protruding portion and to be adjacent to the second protruding portion.

(Configuration 8)

[0365] An electrostatic chuck, comprising: [0366] a ceramic dielectric substrate having a first major surface configured to have a process object placed thereon and a second major surface opposite to the first major surface; [0367] a base plate having an upper surface and a lower surface, the upper surface being at the ceramic dielectric substrate side, the lower surface being opposite to the upper surface, the base plate supporting the ceramic dielectric substrate; and [0368] a heater unit which heats the ceramic dielectric substrate, [0369] the heater unit including a first heater element, [0370] the first heater element being located between the first major surface and the upper surface, [0371] the first heater element including a plurality of zones, [0372] the plurality of zones of the first heater element including a first zone, [0373] the first zone including [0374] a first heater line emitting heat by allowing a current to flow, and [0375] a first power feeding portion and a second power feeding portion feeding power to the first heater line, [0376] the first heater line including a first protruding portion and a second protruding portion that are curved, [0377] a curve direction of the first protruding portion being the opposite of a curve direction of the second protruding portion, [0378] the first zone including a first facing region in which the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other, [0379] the first zone including [0380] a central region positioned at a center of the first zone when viewed along a Z-direction perpendicular to the first major surface, and [0381] an outer peripheral region positioned outside the central region when viewed along the Z-direction, [0382] the first facing region being located in the central region.

(Configuration 9)

[0383] An electrostatic chuck, comprising: [0384] a ceramic dielectric substrate having a first major surface configured to have a process object placed thereon and a second major surface opposite to the first major surface; [0385] a base plate having an upper surface, a lower surface, and a coolant flow path, the upper surface being at the ceramic dielectric substrate side, the lower surface being opposite to the upper surface, the coolant flow path allowing a cooling medium to flow, the base plate supporting the ceramic dielectric substrate; and [0386] a heater unit which heats the ceramic dielectric substrate, [0387] the heater unit including [0388] a first heater element, [0389] a bypass layer that is a power feeding path to the first heater elements, and [0390] a first power feeding terminal and a second power feeding terminal electrically connected to the bypass layer, [0391] the first heater element being located between the first major surface and the upper surface, [0392] the first heater element including a plurality of zones, [0393] the plurality of zones of the first heater element including a first zone, [0394] the first zone including [0395] a first heater line emitting heat by allowing a current to flow, and [0396] a first power feeding portion and a second power feeding portion feeding power to the first heater line, [0397] the first power feeding portion being located at a position where the first power feeding portion does not overlap the first power feeding terminal in a Z-direction perpendicular to the first major surface, [0398] the first power feeding portion being electrically connected to the first power feeding terminal via the bypass layer, [0399] the second power feeding portion being located at a position where the second power feeding portion does not overlap the second power feeding terminal in the Z-direction, [0400] the second power feeding portion being electrically connected to the second power feeding terminal via the bypass layer, [0401] the first heater line including [0402] a plurality of extension portions extending along a first direction, the plurality of extension portions being arranged in a second direction perpendicular to the first direction, and [0403] a plurality of protruding portions provided in the plurality of extension portions, the plurality of protruding portions protruding in the second direction, [0404] the plurality of extension portions including a first extension portion and a

second extension portion, [0405] the plurality of protruding portions including [0406] a first protruding portion provided in the first extension portion, and [0407] a second protruding portion provided in the second extension portion, [0408] the first protruding portion protruding toward the second protruding portion, [0409] the second protruding portion protruding toward the first protruding portion, [0410] the first zone including a first facing region in which the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other, [0411] the first facing region is located at a position where the first facing region overlaps at least one of the first power feeding terminal or the second power feeding terminal in the Z-direction.

(Configuration 10)

[0412] The chuck according to configuration 15 or 16, wherein [0413] the first zone includes [0414] a central region positioned at a center of the first zone when viewed along the Z-direction, and [0415] an outer peripheral region positioned outside the central region when viewed along the Z-direction, and [0416] the first facing region being located in the central region.

(Configuration 11)

[0417] The chuck according to configuration 9 or 10, wherein [0418] the plurality of zones of the first heater element is divided in a radial direction, and [0419] the first direction is a circumferential direction.

(Configuration 12)

[0420] The chuck according to configuration 9 or 10, wherein [0421] the plurality of zones of the first heater element is divided in a radial direction, and [0422] the first direction is the radial direction.

(Configuration 13)

[0423] The chuck according to any one of configurations 9 to 12, wherein [0424] the plurality of extension portions further includes a third extension portion positioned between the first extension portion and the second extension portion in the second direction, and [0425] the third extension portion is located at a position where the third extension portion does not overlap the first and second protruding portions in the second direction.

(Configuration 14)

[0426] The chuck according to configurations 9 to 13, wherein [0427] the plurality of protruding portions further includes a third protruding portion provided in the first extension portion, [0428] the third protruding portion protrudes toward the second protruding portion, and [0429] the third protruding portion is disposed so as to face the second protruding portion and to be adjacent to the second protruding portion.

(Configuration 15)

[0430] An electrostatic chuck, comprising: [0431] a ceramic dielectric substrate having a first major surface configured to have a process object placed thereon and a second major surface opposite to the first major surface; [0432] a base plate having an upper surface, a lower surface, and a coolant flow path, the upper surface being at the ceramic dielectric substrate side, the lower surface being opposite to the upper surface, the coolant flow path allowing a cooling medium to flow, the base plate supporting the ceramic dielectric substrate; and [0433] a heater unit which heats the ceramic dielectric substrate, [0434] the heater unit including [0435] a first heater element, [0436] a second heater element, [0437] a bypass layer that is a power feeding path to the first and second heater elements, and [0438] a first power feeding terminal, a second power feeding terminal, a third power feeding terminal, and a fourth power feeding terminal electrically connected to the bypass layer, [0439] the first heater element being located between the first major surface and the upper surface, [0440] the second heater element being located between the first major surface and the first heater element or between the first heater element and the upper surface, [0441] the first heater element including a plurality of zones, [0442] the plurality of zones of the first heater element including a first zone, [0443] the first zone including [0444] a first heater line emitting heat by allowing a current to flow, and [0445] a first power feeding portion and a second

power feeding portion feeding power to the first heater line, [0446] the first power feeding portion being located at a position where the first power feeding portion does not overlap the first power feeding terminal in a Z-direction perpendicular to the first major surface, [0447] the first power feeding portion being electrically connected to the first power feeding terminal via the bypass layer, [0448] the second power feeding portion being located at a position where the second power feeding portion does not overlap [0449] the second power feeding terminal in the Z-direction, the second power feeding portion being electrically connected to the second power feeding terminal via the bypass layer, [0450] the second heater element including a plurality of zones, [0451] the plurality of zones of the second heater element including a second zone, [0452] the second zone including [0453] a second heater line emitting heat by allowing a current to flow, and [0454] a third power feeding portion and a fourth power feeding portion feeding power to the second heater line, [0455] the third power feeding portion being located at a position where the third power feeding portion does not overlap the third power feeding terminal in the Z-direction, [0456] the third power feeding portion being electrically connected to the third power feeding terminal via the bypass layer, [0457] the fourth power feeding portion being located at a position where the fourth power feeding portion does not overlap the fourth power feeding terminal in the Z-direction, [0458] the fourth power feeding portion being electrically connected to the fourth power feeding terminal via the bypass layer, [0459] at least one of the third power feeding terminal or the fourth power feeding terminal being located at a position where the at least one of the third power feeding terminal or the fourth power feeding terminal overlaps a virtual line segment in the Z-direction, [0460] the virtual line segment connecting a center of the first power feeding portion and a center of the second power feeding portion.

(Configuration 16)

[0461] The chuck according to configuration 15, wherein [0462] at least one of a center of the third power feeding terminal or a center of the fourth power feeding terminal is located at a position where the at least one of the center of the third power feeding terminal or the center of the fourth power feeding terminal overlaps the virtual line segment.

(Configuration 17)

[0463] The chuck according to configuration 15 or 16, wherein [0464] the first zone includes [0465] a central region positioned at a center of the first zone when viewed along the Z-direction, and [0466] an outer peripheral region positioned outside the central region when viewed along the Z-direction, and [0467] at least one of the first power feeding portion or the second power feeding portion is located in the central region.

(Configuration 18)

[0468] The chuck according to configuration 15 or 16, wherein [0469] the first zone includes an outer circumference edge of the first heater element, [0470] the first zone includes: [0471] an inner circumference portion positioned radially inward of a center line of a radial direction, the center line of the radial direction bisecting the first zone in the radial direction; and [0472] an outer circumference portion positioned radially outward of the center line of the radial direction, the outer circumference portion including the outer circumference edge, and [0473] at least one of the first power feeding portion or the second power feeding portion is located in the inner circumference portion.

[0474] Thus, according to embodiments, an electrostatic chuck is provided in which the uniformity of the in-plane temperature distribution of the process object can be increased while suppressing complex temperature control.

[0475] The invention has been described with reference to the embodiments. However, the invention is not limited to these embodiments. Any design changes in the above embodiments suitably made by those skilled in the art are also encompassed within the scope of the invention as long as they fall within the spirit of the invention. For example, the shape, the size the material, the disposition and the arrangement or the like of the components included in the electrostatic chuck

are not limited to illustrations and can be changed appropriately.

[0476] The components included in the embodiments described above can be combined to the extent possible, and these combinations are also encompassed within the scope of the invention as long as they include the features of the invention.

Claims

1. An electrostatic chuck, comprising: a ceramic dielectric substrate having a first major surface configured to have a process object placed thereon and a second major surface opposite to the first major surface; a base plate having an upper surface and a lower surface, the upper surface being at the ceramic dielectric substrate side, the lower surface being opposite to the upper surface, the base plate supporting the ceramic dielectric substrate; and a heater unit which heats the ceramic dielectric substrate, the heater unit including a first heater element, the first heater element being located between the first major surface and the upper surface, the first heater element including a plurality of zones, the plurality of zones of the first heater element including a first zone, the first zone including a first heater line emitting heat by allowing a current to flow, and a first power feeding portion and a second power feeding portion feeding power to the first heater line, the first heater line including a plurality of extension portions extending along a first direction, the plurality of extension portions being arranged in a second direction perpendicular to the first direction, and a plurality of protruding portions provided in the plurality of extension portions, the plurality of protruding portions protruding in the second direction, the plurality of extension portions including a first extension portion and a second extension portion, the plurality of protruding portions including a first protruding portion provided in the first extension portion, and a second protruding portion provided in the second extension portion, the first protruding portion protruding toward the second protruding portion, the second protruding portion protruding toward the first protruding portion, the first zone including a first facing region in which the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other, the first zone including an outer circumference edge of the first heater element, the first zone including an inner circumference portion and an outer circumference portion, the inner circumference portion being a portion positioned at the inner side in the radial direction of a center line of the radial direction, the center line of the radial direction bisecting the first zone in the radial direction, the outer circumference portion being a portion positioned at the other side in the radial direction of the center line of the radial direction, the outer circumference portion including the outer circumference edge, the first facing region being located in the inner circumference portion.
2. The chuck according to claim 1, wherein the plurality of zones of the first heater element is divided in a radial direction, and the first direction is a circumferential direction.
3. The chuck according to claim 1, wherein the plurality of zones of the first heater element is divided in a radial direction, and the first direction is the radial direction.
4. The chuck according to claim 1, wherein the plurality of extension portions further includes a third extension portion positioned between the first extension portion and the second extension portion in the second direction, and the third extension portion is located at a position where the third extension portion does not overlap the first and second protruding portions in the second direction.
5. The chuck according to claim 1, wherein the plurality of protruding portions further includes a third protruding portion provided in the first extension portion, the third protruding portion protrudes toward the second protruding portion, and the third protruding portion is disposed so as to face the second protruding portion and to be adjacent to the second protruding portion.
6. An electrostatic chuck, comprising: a ceramic dielectric substrate having a first major surface configured to have a process object placed thereon and a second major surface opposite to the first major surface; a base plate having an upper surface and a lower surface, the upper surface being at

the ceramic dielectric substrate side, the lower surface being opposite to the upper surface, the base plate supporting the ceramic dielectric substrate; and a heater unit which heats the ceramic dielectric substrate, the heater unit including a first heater element, the first heater element being located between the first major surface and the upper surface, the first heater element including a plurality of zones, the plurality of zones of the first heater element including a first zone, the first zone including a first heater line emitting heat by allowing a current to flow, and a first power feeding portion and a second power feeding portion feeding power to the first heater line, the first heater line including a first protruding portion and a second protruding portion, the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion each being curved, a curve direction of the first protruding portion being opposite to a curve direction of the second protruding portion, the first zone including a first facing region in which the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are disposed so as to face and be adjacent to each other, the first zone including a central region positioned at a center of the first zone when viewed along a Z-direction perpendicular to the first major surface, and an outer peripheral region positioned outside the central region when viewed along the Z-direction, the first facing region being located in the central region.
